

A VANISHING-CYCLE OBSTRUCTION TO SMOOTHING CALABI–YAU THREEFOLDS

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ABSTRACT. A projective Calabi–Yau threefold whose singular points all admit local smoothings need not admit a global one, and when the singularities are not all nodes no general criterion is available. For threefolds whose singularities are ordinary double points and anticanonical cones over del Pezzo surfaces of degrees 6 and 7 we prove a necessity criterion. A one-parameter smoothing produces a rational homology class on the disjoint union of the singularity links which vanishes on a crepant resolution, lies at each cone point in the subspace of $K^\perp \subset H_2$ of the exceptional del Pezzo that dies in the Milnor fibre, where K is the canonical class, and is nonzero at every node, at every degree-7 point, and at a degree-6 point smoothed through the one-parameter component of its miniversal base. The argument does not treat the two-parameter component; the missing period-theoretic input is stated explicitly.

The proof has two principal inputs. A period computation shows that the integral of the holomorphic 3-form over a distinguished vanishing cycle is the local smoothing parameter times a unit. A boundary-marked comparison of the germ Milnor fibre with a del Pezzo threefold complement identifies the cycles that die locally; Mayer–Vietoris then imposes the global relation. In the nodal case the argument recovers the necessity half of Friedman’s relation without assuming unobstructedness or a smooth total space, and the same method applies to the non-local-complete-intersection cone germs.

The resulting criterion is a finite linear-algebra test. It obstructs an anticanonical Batyrev hypersurface with 26 nodes and four del Pezzo cone points although every germ is locally smoothable. It also gives a global obstruction on the mirror partner, independently of that hypersurface’s locally rigid cone germ. Further applications obstruct a seven-vertex hypersurface with one degree-7 cone point and 76 cases in a bounded census of reflexive 4-polytopes with a pentagonal 2-face. For a hypersurface with 14 nodes and one degree-7 point the criterion is silent; its smoothability remains open.

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1. The problem. Let X be a projective threefold over $\mathbb{C}$ with trivial dualizing sheaf and isolated singularities. When every singular germ of X admits a smoothing, one may ask whether X itself does. For ordinary double points the answer is classical: by Friedman’s criterion [Fri86], simultaneous smoothing is governed by a relation among the exceptional curves of a small resolution in which every curve appears with nonzero coefficient; see also Rollenske–Thomas [RT09] for a topological formulation in all odd dimensions. Outside the nodal case much less is known. The local deformation theory of the simplest non-nodal germs, the anticanonical cones over del Pezzo surfaces, has been understood since Altmann [Alt95, Alt97], and their smoothing components have explicit geometric descriptions (Gross [Gro97,

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§5.5]; Petracci [Pet20, Pet19]). What has been missing is a global criterion that couples nodal and divisorial smoothing data.

The first three papers of this program [Wue26a, Wue26b, Wue26c] classified the isolated Gorenstein toric threefold germs arising on Batyrev hypersurfaces from unit-edge polygons and constructed global smoothings when a dual-edge-length invariant is at least two. They also isolated a unique Batyrev mirror pair, associated with a 22-vertex reflexive 4-polytope $\Delta_{\mathbb{F}_1}$ and its polar, for which both members have only isolated singularities. The remaining smoothing question is *mixed*: nodes and del Pezzo cone points occur on the same threefold, so any smoothing must move both kinds at once. One member carries a cone singularity with no smoothing and is locally obstructed. The other, denoted X° throughout, has 26 ordinary double points, two anticanonical cones over the del Pezzo surface of degree 7, and two over the del Pezzo surface of degree 6: thirty germs, every one of them locally smoothable. A purely nodal analysis cannot decide X° : two of its twenty-six nodes are *coloops* of the relation matrix, meaning that their coordinate vanishes on every relation among the classes of the exceptional curves of a small resolution, so no nodal relation is nonzero there and any smoothing would have to recruit the divisorial deformation directions.

1.2. Results. Fix the following setting. X is a compact complex threefold with $\omega_X \cong \mathcal{O}_X$ and $h^1(\mathcal{O}_X) = 0$ whose singular points are ordinary double points and anticanonical cones over del Pezzo surfaces of degrees 6 and 7; $\pi: \hat{X} \rightarrow X$ is a crepant resolution, small over the nodes and with an exceptional del Pezzo surface E_p over each cone point p . For a singular point p let L_p denote its link. A *one-parameter deformation* of X is a flat proper analytic family $\mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$ over a disk $\mathbb{D}$ with $\mathcal{X}_0 \cong X$, and it is a *one-parameter smoothing* if X_s is smooth for all $s \neq 0$. Such a smoothing induces at each singular point a smoothing of the local germ, with Milnor fiber $\mathcal{M}_p$, and we set

$$\mathcal{R}_p := \ker(H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(\mathcal{M}_p; \mathbb{Q})),$$

the part of the link homology that bounds in the local Milnor fiber. By Altman's computation, recalled in Section 2.2, the miniversal base of a node or of a degree-7 cone germ has one reduced component, and that of a degree-6 cone germ has two, of dimensions 1 and 2; a smoothing sends the germ into one of them, and $\mathcal{R}_p$ depends on which.

Theorem A (mixed necessity; = Theorem 6.1). *Suppose X as above admits a one-parameter smoothing. Then the space*

$$K(X) := \left\{ \kappa \in \ker \left(\bigoplus_p H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q}) \right) : \kappa_p \in \mathcal{R}_p \text{ at every cone point } p \right\}$$

contains, for every node q , for every degree-7 cone point q , and for every degree-6 cone point q whose induced local smoothing lies in the one-parameter component of its miniversal base, a class κ with $\kappa_q \neq 0$. Here the maps are induced by the inclusions $L_p \subset X \setminus \text{Sing } X \subset \hat{X}$.

The subspaces $\mathcal{R}_p$ are computed in closed form (Proposition 2.1): at a degree-7 point $\mathcal{R}_p$ is the unique line spanned by a (-2) -class of $K^\perp \subset H_2(E_p; \mathbb{Q})$, and at a degree-6 point it is the A_1 or the A_2 summand of the root lattice $K^\perp \cong A_1 \oplus A_2$, according to the component of the local miniversal base through which the family smooths the germ. These subspaces coincide with the lattices $\Xi(V)$ attached by Kuznetsov–Prokhorov [KP23, Theorem 1.9] to the del Pezzo threefolds V that sweep out the local smoothings.

Theorem A is a finite linear-algebra test on any concrete X . It is finite although $\mathcal{R}_p$ refers to a smoothing whose existence is in question, because the degree-6 points contribute only

finitely many choices of component: one runs the test on each, as Section 9.1 does. On the distinguished hypersurface every choice obstructs.

Theorem B (= Theorem 6.5 and Corollary 6.7). *Let X° be an anticanonical hypersurface, regular in Batyrev's sense [Bat94, Def. 3.1.1], in the Gorenstein Fano toric fourfold associated with the polar of $\Delta_{\mathbb{F}_1}$, the 22-vertex reflexive polytope printed in Table 3 whose polar is printed in Table 1. Then X° admits no one-parameter smoothing. Moreover no fiber of a small representative of the miniversal deformation of X° is smooth, and no formal arc in the miniversal deformation of X° meets all thirty local smoothing loci.*

Theorems A and B are the main results. The first is the general topological necessity statement; the second is its application to the mixed Batyrev hypersurface that motivated the criterion.

Call a Batyrev mirror pair *doubly isolated* when both members have only isolated singularities. The companion classification [Wue26d] identifies X° and X_Δ as the unique such pair in the family it treats. The mirror partner X_Δ carries an anticanonical cone over $\mathbb{F}_1$, a germ with no smoothing [Wue26a, Wue26c], so both members of the pair are non-smoothable. The criterion says more. Extended to deformations that leave such a germ in place (Section 7), it shows that X_Δ carries the global obstruction as well: two of its twenty nodes are smoothed by no one-parameter deformation at all, and this is independent of the $\mathbb{F}_1$ germ, which already prevents a smoothing for a purely local reason. The two members of the pair are therefore not an instance of one obstruction seen locally and globally; each fails globally, and one of them fails locally in addition.

The analytic core of Theorem A is quantitative: the period of the holomorphic 3-form of the nearby fiber over the vanishing cycle of a node equals the local smoothing parameter times a unit (Lemma 3.1), and an analogous nonvanishing holds for the distinguished cycles of the degree-7 and one-parameter degree-6 smoothings (Lemma 3.3), where the decisive constant is an explicit period equal to $4\pi^2$ on a cycle we construct by hand. Consequently a smoothed germ cannot have rationally null-homologous vanishing homology, at any order of tangency of the family with the local discriminants. In the purely nodal case this yields:

Corollary 1.1 (Corollary 6.3). *For a compact complex threefold with $\omega \cong \mathcal{O}$, $h^1(\mathcal{O}) = 0$ and only ordinary double points, any one-parameter smoothing forces, for every node q , the existence of a relation among the exceptional curve classes of a small resolution that is nonzero at q . This is the necessity half of Friedman's criterion. It is not new in the nodal case: [Nam02, Theorem 2.5] proves the equivalence for threefolds with terminal singularities, and [Col25, §4] gives a differential-geometric proof of necessity. What the method adds is that it needs no unobstructedness and no hypothesis of a smooth total space, and that it survives at germs which are not local complete intersections, where those two literatures stop.*

For X° the exact finite input localizes the obstruction topologically:

Proposition 1.2 (Proposition 6.4). *In any hypothetical one-parameter smoothing of X° , the vanishing 3-spheres of the two coloop nodes would be null-homologous in $H_3(X_s; \mathbb{Q})$.*

Lemma 3.1 says that a smoothed node has a nonzero vanishing-cycle class, whereas Proposition 1.2 makes that class zero at either coloop node. This contradiction proves Theorem B. A complementary second proof, with a different period input, runs through a degree-7 point instead of the nodes (Section 6).

The one-germ result and the bounded census are applications of the general criterion rather than additional main theorems. On the seven-vertex polytope Δ_7 , the unique singularity is a

degree-7 cone and its root line survives in $H_2(\widehat{X}; \mathbb{Q})$, so Corollary 9.1 obstructs a smoothing. Among the 77 admissible polytopes with at most nine vertices and a pentagonal 2-face, the same test obstructs 76 (Proposition 9.2).

Section 8 supplies structural interpretations of the finite test. To compute the topological kernel, we pair the link classes against ambient divisor classes. This produces, at each singular point, one linear functional on $K^\perp$ for each such divisor; we assemble them into an integer matrix and call the functionals contributed by a single germ its *rows*. Three statements about that construction are proved there. The rows at a germ form a rational basis of T^1 after extension of scalars, so the lattice $K^\perp$, which enters as a substitute for the exceptional curve class a cone point does not have, is a rational form of the tangent space to the germ's deformation functor (Proposition 8.2). Batyrev's correction term for $h^{1,1}$ vanishes on the whole class, so the kernel computed from the ambient Picard group is the topological kernel and not merely contained in it (Proposition 8.3). And $\mathbb{Q}$ -factoriality of X forces the rows at a divisorial germ to vanish, so a germ whose rows do not all vanish certifies that X is not $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial (Proposition 8.4). The last of these is what reconciles the criterion with Gross's theorem that a primitive contraction of a dP_7 divisor to a point has smoothable target [Gro97, Theorem 5.8]: primitivity supplies $\mathbb{Q}$ -factoriality, which is exactly the case in which the criterion says nothing.

The criterion does not obstruct every mixed example. Applying the same finite test to the anticanonical hypersurface X_{19} of a 19-vertex reflexive polytope from the companion paper [Wue26c] (fourteen nodes and one degree-7 cone point, again with two nodal coloops), the finite test is silent: no coordinate to which Theorem A's nonvanishing conclusion applies is forced to vanish (Section 9), and we ask:

Question 1.3. Is X_{19} smoothable? Any smoothing of X_{19} would be a simultaneous smoothing of nodal and del Pezzo cone singularities that no purely nodal mechanism can produce.

1.3. Method. The general necessity theorem has two inputs. First, the vanishing-period computations of Section 3 convert nonvanishing of local smoothing parameters into nonvanishing homology classes. Second, the local-to-global membership statement requires a boundary-marked topological comparison. The germ Milnor fiber is identified with a del Pezzo threefold complement as a manifold with boundary, compatibly with the two natural circle fibrations of the link (Lemma 4.2); together with the classification of del Pezzo threefolds of degrees 6 and 7 (Fujita [Fuj80]), this computes the subspaces $\mathcal{R}_p$. Surgery along the links and Mayer–Vietoris then place the boundary of every 3-cycle of X_s in the space $K(X)$ of Theorem A. Its application to X° adds a third input: an exact integral computation on a fixed crepant resolution shows that on the relevant restricted kernels the coordinates of the two coloop nodes and of the degree-7 directions vanish identically (Section 5); all decisive matrix data are printed, and Appendix A lists the programs that recompute them.

The argument does *not* use the first-order deformation theory of X beyond motivation: the localization map, its image, and the comparison of coordinate systems on local deformation spaces never enter. It is insensitive to the order of tangency of the smoothing family with the local discriminants, the phenomenon that blocks first-order methods: the necessity statements of [Fri86, RT09] concern the first-order data of a deformation class, and their proofs are specific to nodes (one-dimensional local T^1 , quadric exceptional geometry), whereas the periods above see the actual arc. Neither does it use unobstructedness, which is unavailable for the non-lci cone germs.

1.4. Relation to prior work. Friedman [Fri86] proved the nodal criterion; Rollenske–Thomas [RT09] gave a topological proof and the higher-dimensional statement, in both cases for first-order data, with the passage to actual smoothings supplied by unobstructedness (Kawamata, Tian, Ran) in the nodal case. Namikawa [Nam02, Theorem 2.5] proved the nodal statement as an equivalence, for terminal singularities, and Collins [Col25, §4] proves necessity there by a differential-geometric argument. In the opposite direction, Aguilar [Agu26] shows that in the log Fano setting the analogous balancing conditions vanish and local smoothings of nodes lift independently, so no relation is forced; the contrast marks how much of the present obstruction is Calabi–Yau specific. Ning [Nin26] extends the local-freeness theorem of Friedman–Laza beyond the local complete intersection case, which is the direction from which the barrier recorded in Section 10.3 would be lifted, though that work states no smoothing criterion. Friedman’s recent unobstructedness theorem allows isolated Du Bois singularities under broad analytic hypotheses, but its unobstructedness conclusion still assumes that the singularities are local complete intersections [Fri25]. Friedman–Laza [FL25, FL24] identify the first-order localization data of threefolds with isolated singularities in terms of link homology; our Section 5 uses only the resolution-side avatar of that picture, in the form of an integral matrix. Gross [Gro97] determined the smoothing components of the del Pezzo cone germs; Altmann [Alt95, Alt97] computed their miniversal deformations; Petracci [Pet20, Pet19] and Kaloghiros–Petracci [KP21] give modern treatments, the latter computing the Betti numbers of the degree-6 Milnor fibers, in agreement with Section 2. The classification of the sweeping del Pezzo threefolds is due to Fujita [Fuj80]; we follow Fujita in recording that the degree-6 case of Iskovskikh’s earlier list omits $\mathbb{P}(T_{\mathbb{P}^2})$, and cite Fujita, with Kuznetsov–Prokhorov [KP23] as the modern reference. On the constructive side, multi-parameter deformations of toric varieties in a single character degree were built by Ilten–Vollmert [IV12]; the sufficiency counterpart of Theorem A, in particular Question 1.3, is the subject of work in progress and is not addressed here.

Convention 1.4. dP_d denotes a del Pezzo *surface* of degree $d = K^2$; thus $\mathrm{dP}_6 = \mathrm{Bl}_3 \mathbb{P}^2$ and $\mathrm{dP}_7 = \mathrm{Bl}_2 \mathbb{P}^2$. A *del Pezzo threefold* is a smooth projective threefold V with $-K_V = 2H$ for an ample H ; its degree is H^3 . For a polygon or polytope, edges are *unit* if they have lattice length one. Homology and cohomology have $\mathbb{Q}$ -coefficients unless stated otherwise. The anticanonical cone over a del Pezzo surface S is $C(S) = \mathrm{Spec} \bigoplus_{k \geq 0} H^0(S, -kK_S)$.

2. THE GERMS: LINKS, MINIVERSAL BASES, MILNOR FIBERS

Throughout this section $(Y, 0) = C(S)$ is the anticanonical cone over a smooth del Pezzo surface S , an isolated Gorenstein toric threefold singularity when S is toric. For $S = \mathrm{dP}_6$, dP_7 and $\mathbb{F}_1$, the cases used in this paper, it is the toric variety of the cone over the unit-edge reflexive hexagon, pentagon and quadrilateral respectively, placed at height one. (The unit-edge polygon here is the *fan* polygon of S ; its polar, the Newton polygon of $-K_S$, is not unit-edge for the pentagon.)

2.1. Links. The punctured cone is the total space of $\mathcal{O}_S(K_S)$ minus its zero section, so the link L is the unit circle bundle of $\mathcal{O}_S(K_S)$, and the homology Gysin sequence together with $H_1(S) = 0$ gives a canonical isomorphism

$$(1) \quad H_2(L; \mathbb{Q}) \cong K_S^\perp \subset H_2(S; \mathbb{Q}),$$

of rank 3 for dP_6 and 2 for dP_7 . For a node, $L \cong S^2 \times S^3$ and $H_2(L; \mathbb{Q}) = \mathbb{Q}$. The lattice $K^\perp(\mathrm{dP}_6)$ is the root lattice $A_1 \oplus A_2$ (discriminant 6); $K^\perp(\mathrm{dP}_7)$ has discriminant 7 and contains exactly one pair $\pm$ of primitive classes of square -2 .

2.2. Miniversal deformations. By Altmann's theorems, the deformation theory of these germs is completely explicit. T^1 is concentrated in the Gorenstein character degree, of dimension $n - 3$ for an n -gon [Alt95, (6.5) and the subsequent Remark]; the versal family in that degree, constructed in [Alt97], is therefore a versal deformation of the affine cone, with base ring computed there:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{dP}_7 &: \mathbb{C}[s_1, s_2]/(s_1^2, s_1 s_2) & [\text{Alt97}, (9.1)(\mathrm{v})], \\ \mathrm{dP}_6 &: \mathbb{C}[s_1, s_2, s_3]/(s_1 s_3, s_2 s_3) & [\text{Alt97}, (2.5)]. \end{aligned}$$

The reduced components correspond to the maximal decompositions of the polygon into Minkowski sums of lattice polygons [Alt97, (2.5), (8.1)]: the pentagon decomposes in exactly one way, into a unit segment pair and a unimodular triangle, giving one reduced component, the line $\{s_1 = 0\}$; the hexagon decomposes as a sum of two triangles (the line $\{s_1 = s_2 = 0\}$) and as a sum of three segments (the plane $\{s_3 = 0\}$).

We record three standard supplements used later. First, *minimality*: the Kodaira–Spencer map of Altmann's family is an isomorphism onto T^1 [Alt97, (6.2), (6.3)], so the versal family is miniversal. Second, *the germ*: T^1 and T^2 of the affine cone are finite-dimensional and supported at the vertex, and the deformation theory of the affine variety is identified with that of the analytic germ $(Y, 0)$ by Artin approximation [Art69]; the analytic miniversal deformation exists by Grauert [Gra72]; the base is the analytic germ of the ring displayed above. (The versality criterion used in [Alt97, (7.2)] is that of de Jong–van Straten [dJvS94, §4].) Third, *arcs*: a morphism from the germ of a disk to the miniversal base factors through the reduction and, since the analytic local ring of a disk is a domain, lies in a single reduced component; for the pentagon base this forces $s_1 \equiv 0$ along any arc, and for the hexagon base it forces the arc into the line or into the plane. We refer to the corresponding local smoothings as smoothings *through* the given component.

2.3. Sweeps and Milnor fibers. The smoothing components of these cones are cones swept by hyperplane sections, in the sense of Pinkham [Pin74, (4.2), (5.1), (5.5)]; see [PP15, Lemma 4.1, Proposition 4.2] for the statement in all dimensions in the pencil form used here. Concretely (Gross [Gro97, §5.5]; Petracci [Pet20, Proposition 2.2], [Pet19, Proposition 4.12]): the general fiber of the degree-7 smoothing is $V_7 \setminus \bar{S}$ with $V_7 = \mathrm{Bl}_{pt} \mathbb{P}^3$; the general fiber of the hexagon's one-parameter (line) component is $(\mathbb{P}^1)^3 \setminus \bar{S}$; and that of its two-parameter (plane) component is $W_6 \setminus \bar{S}$ with $W_6 = \mathbb{P}(T_{\mathbb{P}^2})$ the divisor of bidegree $(1, 1)$ in $\mathbb{P}^2 \times \mathbb{P}^2$. In each case V is a del Pezzo threefold of the same degree with $\bar{S} \in |H|$ a copy of S , embedded by $-K_S = H|_{\bar{S}}$; the classification of the possible V (Fujita [Fuj80, (5.8), (5.16)]) shows there are no others. For the record, the open Milnor fibers of the three branches have $(b_2, b_3) = (1, 1)$, $(2, 1)$ and $(1, 2)$ respectively; the degree-6 values agree with [KP21, Proposition 3.5].

Proposition 2.1. *Let $\mathcal{M} = V \setminus \bar{S}$ be one of the three sweep complements. Under the identification (1) of H_2 of the link $L = \partial(\text{tube around } \bar{S})$ with $K_S^\perp$,*

$$\ker(H_2(L; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(\mathcal{M}; \mathbb{Q})) = \ker(K_S^\perp \rightarrow H_2(V; \mathbb{Q})) = \begin{cases} \text{the } (-2)\text{-line} & V = V_7, \\ A_1 & V = (\mathbb{P}^1)^3, \\ A_2 & V = W_6, \end{cases}$$

where the map is the restriction to $K^\perp$ of the pushforward $H_2(S; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(V; \mathbb{Q})$. For a node, $\ker(H_2(L; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(\mathcal{M}; \mathbb{Q})) = H_2(L; \mathbb{Q}) = \mathbb{Q}$.

Proof. Since $\bar{S}$ is an ample divisor with $H_1(\bar{S}) = 0$, the Thom isomorphism gives $H_3(V, \mathcal{M}) \cong H_1(\bar{S}) = 0$, so $H_2(\mathcal{M}) \hookrightarrow H_2(V)$, and the inclusion $L \subset \mathcal{M}$ composed with this injection

factors, up to homotopy through the tube, as the projection $L \rightarrow \bar{S}$ followed by $\bar{S} \subset V$; the two kernels therefore coincide. The pushforward is computed in the standard bases. For V_7 : a smooth member of $|H| = |2H_{\mathbb{P}^3} - E|$ is the strict transform of a quadric through the blown-up point, so $\bar{S} \cong \text{Bl}_2 \mathbb{P}^2$ with $H_{\mathbb{P}^3}|_{\bar{S}} = 2\ell - e_1 - e_2$ and $E|_{\bar{S}} = \ell - e_1 - e_2$; the pushforward matrix has rows $(2, 1), (1, 1), (1, 1)$ on (ℓ, e_1, e_2) and kernel $\langle e_1 - e_2 \rangle$, which is the (-2) -line. For $(\mathbb{P}^1)^3$: the three projections restrict to the conic pencils $|\ell - e_i|$, the rows are $(1, 1, 1)$ and the unit vectors, and the kernel is $\langle \ell - e_1 - e_2 - e_3 \rangle = A_1$. For W_6 : the two contractions restrict to ℓ and $2\ell - e_1 - e_2 - e_3$, and the kernel is $\langle e_1 - e_2, e_2 - e_3 \rangle = A_2$. For the node, $\mathcal{M} \simeq T^*S^3$ has $H_2 = 0$. $\square$

Remark 2.2. The three kernels are the lattices $\Xi(V)$ of Kuznetsov–Prokhorov: [KP23, Theorem 1.9(i)] states $\text{Cl}(V) \cong \Xi(V)^\perp \subset \text{Cl}(\bar{S})$ with $\Xi(V)$ negative definite of rank $10 - d - \rho(V)$, giving A_1, A_1, A_2 for $V_7, (\mathbb{P}^1)^3, W_6$, an independent confirmation.

2.4. Which sweep for which component. The one-parameter (line) component of the hexagon base sweeps to $(\mathbb{P}^1)^3$ and the two-parameter (plane) component to W_6 : this is stated in [Pet20, Proposition 2.2], follows from [Alt95, (7.1.5)] (the total spaces over the two components are the cones over $(\mathbb{P}^1)^3$ and over $\mathbb{P}^2 \times \mathbb{P}^2$, whose anticanonical hyperplane slice is W_6), and is confirmed numerically by the Betti numbers quoted above against [KP21, Proposition 3.5]. The results of Sections 3–6 are stated so that only the degree-7 branch and the fact that each degree-6 kernel is A_1 or A_2 enter the main theorem; the matching is used only in the sharper form of Theorem 6.1(3).

3. VANISHING PERIODS

This section contains the analytic mechanism. Throughout, $\mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$ is a one-parameter smoothing of a compact complex threefold X with $\omega_X \cong \mathcal{O}_X$, $h^1(\mathcal{O}_X) = 0$ and isolated singularities of the types in Theorem A.

3.1. A relative holomorphic 3-form. Flatness and the Gorenstein property of all fibers make $\mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$ a Gorenstein morphism after shrinking the disk, so the relative dualizing sheaf $\omega_{\mathcal{X}/\mathbb{D}}$ is invertible and compatible with base change [Con00]. We first prove $c_1(\omega_{X_s}) = 0$ integrally. Choose the disjoint good representatives and exterior W of Section 4.1. Over a neighborhood of W the family is a smooth proper submersion with boundary and hence is C^∞ -trivial. Since $\omega_X|_W \cong \mathcal{O}_W$, the restriction of $c_1(\omega_{\mathcal{X}/\mathbb{D}})$ to the corresponding exterior in X_s vanishes. On each local piece it also vanishes: choose first a Stein contractible neighborhood N_p of $(p, 0)$ in $\mathcal{X}$, on which the invertible sheaf $\omega_{\mathcal{X}/\mathbb{D}}$ is trivial, and then the good representative U_p inside N_p .

For every boundary link in this paper, $H^1(L_p; \mathbb{Z}) = 0$. This is immediate for the nodal link $S^2 \times S^3$. For a cone point, L_p is the circle bundle of $\mathcal{O}_S(K_S)$ over the simply connected del Pezzo surface S ; the homotopy sequence shows that $\pi_1(L_p)$ is the cyclic group $\mathbb{Z}/d$, where d is the divisibility of the Euler class $K_S \neq 0$, because the connecting map $\pi_2(S) \rightarrow \pi_1(S^1) = \mathbb{Z}$ is evaluation against K_S . Hence $H^1(L_p; \mathbb{Z}) = \text{Hom}(\mathbb{Z}/d, \mathbb{Z}) = 0$ for every del Pezzo cone point, whether or not K_S is primitive. (It is primitive for dP_6, dP_7 and $\mathbb{F}_1$, where L_p is simply connected, but not for $\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^1$.) The Mayer–Vietoris sequence for $X_s = W \cup \bigsqcup_p \mathcal{M}_p$ therefore injects

$$H^2(X_s; \mathbb{Z}) \hookrightarrow H^2(W; \mathbb{Z}) \oplus \bigoplus_p H^2(\mathcal{M}_p; \mathbb{Z}).$$

The preceding local vanishings give $c_1(\omega_{X_s}) = 0$. Semicontinuity gives $h^1(\mathcal{O}_{X_s}) = 0$; the exponential sequence then embeds $\text{Pic}(X_s)$ into $H^2(X_s; \mathbb{Z})$ and forces $\omega_{X_s} \cong \mathcal{O}_{X_s}$. (The

hypothesis $\omega_X \cong \mathcal{O}_X$ cannot be dropped: the cone over a smooth quadric surface in $\mathbb{P}^4$ is a one-node threefold smoothed by the family of quadric threefolds, and the vanishing cycle of that smoothing *is* null-homologous; that example satisfies $h^1(\mathcal{O}_X) = 0$ and is excluded here exactly because $\omega_X \cong \mathcal{O}_X(-3)$ is nontrivial. The hypothesis $h^1(\mathcal{O}_X) = 0$ enters only through the exponential sequence in the previous sentence.) Constants and upper semicontinuity give $h^0(\mathcal{O}_{X_s}) = 1$ after shrinking, hence $h^0(\omega_{X_s}) = 1$. By Grauert's base-change theorem [Gra60], $\pi_*\omega_{\mathcal{X}/\mathbb{D}}$ is then a line bundle on the shrunk disk; we fix a trivializing section Ω , whose restriction Ω_s generates the invertible sheaf ω_{X_s} and is therefore a nowhere-vanishing holomorphic 3-form on the smooth locus of X_s for $s \neq 0$ and a generator of ω_X near each singular point at $s = 0$.

3.2. Nodes.

Lemma 3.1. *Let p be an ordinary double point of X . Then the vanishing-cycle class $\delta_p(s) \in H_3(X_s; \mathbb{Q})$ is nonzero for all small $s \neq 0$.*

Proof. The germ (X, p) is $\{xy - zw = 0\} \subset (\mathbb{C}^4, 0)$, with miniversal deformation $\{xy - zw = u\}$ over the u -line [KS72]. The family induces a classifying map $s \mapsto \tilde{u}(s)$, holomorphic with $\tilde{u}(0) = 0$ (only its nonvanishing at each fixed $s \neq 0$ is used, which is independent of choices), and X_s is smooth near p exactly when $\tilde{u}(s) \neq 0$; the hypothesis gives $\tilde{u}(s) \neq 0$ for all small $s \neq 0$. The pullback total space is the hypersurface $\{xy - zw = \tilde{u}(s)\}$, Gorenstein even at its singular points, and adjunction exhibits $\omega_{\mathcal{X}/\mathbb{D}}$ near p as generated by the relative Gelfand–Leray form $\text{GL}_u = \text{Res}[dx dy dz dw / (xy - zw - u)]$. Hence $\Omega = g \cdot \text{GL}$ with g holomorphic on the total-space germ and $g(p, 0) \neq 0$; extend g to an ambient holomorphic function so that $g(0, s)$ is defined.

After the linear change putting $xy - zw$ into the form $\sum_{i=1}^4 v_i^2$, the vanishing cycle over u is the real slice $\delta_u = \sqrt{u} \cdot S^3$, whose class is single-valued: in fiber dimension three the Picard–Lefschetz transvection fixes δ (as $\langle \delta, \delta \rangle = 0$), and the antipodal ambiguity of $\sqrt{u}$ acts on S^3 with degree $+1$. Under $v \mapsto \lambda v$ one has $u \mapsto \lambda^2 u$ and $\text{GL} \mapsto \lambda^2 \text{GL}$, so the local period is exactly linear:

$$\int_{\delta_u} \text{GL}_u = c_0 u, \quad c_0 = \int_{S^3} \frac{dv_1 dv_2 dv_3}{2v_4} = \pi^2 \neq 0$$

up to orientation conventions. For the twisted form, expanding the ambient extension $g = g(p, s) + O(|v|)$ and using $|v| = |u|^{1/2}$ on δ_u gives

$$F(u, s) := \int_{\delta_u} g \cdot \text{GL}_u = u (c_0 g(p, s) + O(|u|^{1/2})),$$

so $F(u, s) = u \cdot (\text{unit})$ near $(0, 0)$; here u, s are independent until the substitution $u = \tilde{u}(s)$.

Suppose $\delta_p(s_0) = 0$ in $H_3(X_{s_0}; \mathbb{Q})$ for some small $s_0 \neq 0$. A nonzero integer multiple of the cycle then bounds, and Ω_{s_0} is closed, so $\int_{\delta_p(s_0)} \Omega_{s_0} = 0$. But this period equals $F(\tilde{u}(s_0), s_0) = \tilde{u}(s_0) \cdot (\text{unit}) \neq 0$, a contradiction. $\square$

3.3. Del Pezzo cone points. For the cone germs the same strategy applies, with the local model family replaced by the sweep and the explicit period computed on the sweep complement. Both relevant complements admit a uniform toric description. Let V be $(\mathbb{P}^1)^3$ or $\text{Bl}_{pt} \mathbb{P}^3$ with its fan in $N \cong \mathbb{Z}^3$, and let $m \in N^\vee$ be the character $(1, 1, 1)$, respectively $(1, 1, -1)$ in the basis where the fan of $\text{Bl}_{pt} \mathbb{P}^3$ has rays e_1, e_2, e_3 , $r = -e_1 - e_2 - e_3$ and

$e_1 + e_2 + e_3$. In both cases $\langle m, v \rangle = \pm 1$ on every ray, the closure $\bar{S}$ of $\{\chi^m = 1\}$ is a copy of the appropriate del Pezzo surface with $[\bar{S}] = -\frac{1}{2}K_V$, and

$$(2) \quad \Omega_{\mathcal{M}} = \frac{w}{(w-1)^2} \frac{dx}{x} \wedge \frac{dy}{y} \wedge \frac{dz}{z}, \quad w = \chi^m,$$

is the generator of $\omega(V \setminus \bar{S}) \cong \mathcal{O}$, unique up to scale: the order of (2) along a boundary divisor D_v is $\langle m, v \rangle - 2 \min(\langle m, v \rangle, 0) - 1 = 0$, and along $\bar{S}$ it is -2 . Here uniqueness is algebraic. If $f \in \mathcal{O}(V \setminus \bar{S})^\times$, then $\operatorname{div}_V(f) = n\bar{S}$ for some $n \in \mathbb{Z}$; since $\operatorname{Pic}(V)$ is torsion-free and $[\bar{S}] \neq 0$, one has $n = 0$, and a rational function without zeros or poles on the projective variety V is constant.

Lemma 3.2. *In each of the two complements $\mathcal{M} = V \setminus \bar{S}$ above there is a closed 3-cycle $T \subset \mathcal{M}$ with $\int_T \Omega_{\mathcal{M}} = \pm 4\pi^2$. Consequently $[\Omega_{\mathcal{M}}] \neq 0$ in $H^3(\mathcal{M}; \mathbb{C})$, and since $b_3(\mathcal{M}) = 1$, the period pairing $H_3(\mathcal{M}; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$, $\nu \mapsto \int_\nu \Omega_{\mathcal{M}}$, is injective.*

Proof. Choose an edge $\langle v_+, v_- \rangle$ of the fan with $\langle m, v_\pm \rangle = \pm 1$ and an adjacent maximal cone $\langle v_+, v_-, n_0 \rangle$ with $\langle m, n_0 \rangle = +1$; such pairs exist in both cases and any admissible choice works. The two cases are

V	$(v_+, v_-, n_0; n_1)$	transition to the n_1 chart	c
$(\mathbb{P}^1)^3$	$(e_1, -e_2, e_3; -e_3)$	$(p, q, 1/z)$	0
$\operatorname{Bl}_{pt} \mathbb{P}^3$	$(e_1, r, e_2; e_3)$	$(p/z, q/z, 1/z)$	-1

where c is the z -exponent of the transition monomial for p' . In the unimodular chart with coordinates (p, q, z) dual to (v_+, v_-, n_0) one has $w = pq^{-1}z$, $\bar{S} = \{t = 0\}$ with $t = q - pz$, and $\Omega_{\mathcal{M}} = \pm dp \wedge dq \wedge dz/t^2$. Fix $\varepsilon > 0$, $R > 1$ and set

$$T_1 = \{p = 0, q = \varepsilon R e^{i\psi}, |z| \leq R\},$$

$$T_2 = \{p = r\varepsilon e^{i\theta}, q = -(1-r)\varepsilon R e^{i(\theta+\varphi)}, z = R e^{i\varphi}\}, \quad r \in [0, 1],$$

$$T_3 = \{p' = \varepsilon R^c e^{i\psi}, q' = 0, |z'| \leq 1/R\} \quad \text{in the chart at the opposite corner } n_1,$$

where (p', q', z') are the dual coordinates of (v_+, v_-, n_1) and c is as in the table. The corner-chart cap is necessary: in the $\operatorname{Bl}_{pt} \mathbb{P}^3$ case the naive closure of $\{|p| = \varepsilon, q = 0, |z| \geq R\}$ collapses onto the torus-fixed point of the corner chart, which lies on $\bar{S} = \{p' = q'z'\}$; the cap T_3 instead keeps $|p' - q'z'| = \varepsilon R^c > 0$. On T_2 , $t = -\varepsilon R e^{i(\theta+\varphi)}$ has constant modulus; the $r = 0$ boundary is the boundary torus of T_1 and the $r = 1$ boundary maps under the transition onto ∂T_3 , so with orientations of the caps chosen to cancel ∂T_2 , $T = T_1 + T_2 + T_3$ is a closed 3-cycle in $\mathcal{M}$.

The pullback of $\Omega_{\mathcal{M}}$ to T_1 and T_3 vanishes identically ($dp \mapsto 0$, respectively $dq' \mapsto 0$, while $\Omega_{\mathcal{M}}$ is regular there), and on T_2 the pullback of $dp \wedge dq \wedge dz/t^2$ is the constant form $dr \wedge d\theta \wedge d\varphi$: writing it out, the complex Jacobian of the parametrization equals t^2 exactly. Hence $\int_T \Omega_{\mathcal{M}} = \int_0^1 \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} dr d\theta d\varphi = 4\pi^2$ up to the orientation sign.

Finally $b_3(\mathcal{M}) = 1$: from the pair sequence of $(V, \mathcal{M})$ and $H^3(V) = 0$, $b_3(\mathcal{M})$ is the corank of the restriction $H^2(V; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H^2(\bar{S}; \mathbb{Q})$, which is one in both cases. $\square$

Lemma 3.3. *Let p be a singular point of X whose germ is the anticanonical cone over dP_7 , or over dP_6 with the induced local smoothing through the one-parameter component. Then $H_3(\mathcal{M}_p; \mathbb{Q}) (\cong \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_3(X_s; \mathbb{Q})$ is injective for all small $s \neq 0$.*

Proof. By Section 2.2 the induced arc lies in a single reduced component c of the miniversal base of the germ, off the local discriminant for $s \neq 0$, and by Section 2.3 the Milnor fiber is the corresponding sweep complement, which for the two branches in the statement is one of the complements of Lemma 3.2. The component carries Pinkham's $\mathbb{C}^*$ -equivariant swept family with parameters of weight one (Section 2.2: T^1 sits in the Gorenstein degree); let Ω^{loc} be an equivariant algebraic generator of its relative dualizing sheaf, homogeneous of some integral weight a . To construct it, work in the graded local ring at the vertex. The relative dualizing module is invertible, and graded Nakayama selects from any algebraic local generator a homogeneous component that still generates. Call U the open locus on which that homogeneous generator generates; U is $\mathbb{C}^*$ -stable, being the nonvanishing locus of a homogeneous section, and it contains the vertex. Then U contains the whole fiber $b = 1$. Let x be a point of that fiber. Scaling the positive-weight cone coordinates and the weight-one parameter to zero carries x to the vertex, so the vertex lies in the closure of $\mathbb{C}^* \cdot x$; since U is open and contains the vertex, some $\lambda \cdot x$ lies in U , and since U is $\mathbb{C}^*$ -stable, x does. Thus the restriction to $b = 1$ is an algebraic generator of $\omega_{\mathcal{M}}$, hence a constant multiple of $\Omega_{\mathcal{M}}$ by the unit calculation following (2); rescale it so that $\Omega^{\text{loc}}|_{b=1} = \Omega_{\mathcal{M}}$. For a horizontal family ν of classes in $H_3(\mathcal{M}; \mathbb{Q})$,

$$\int_{\nu(b)} \Omega_b^{\text{loc}} = c(\nu) \cdot \chi(b),$$

with χ the weight- a monomial in the component parameter and $c(\nu) = \int_{\nu} \Omega_{\mathcal{M}}$: single-valuedness holds because the $\mathbb{C}^*$ -action is a group action on the total space with parameter weight one, so transport once around the base circle is the identity; and $c(\cdot)$ is linear. Writing $\Omega = g \cdot \Omega^{\text{loc}}$ near p with g a unit as in Section 3.1, let $b = b(s)$ be the actual parameter of the component. The cycle obtained from the fixed compact cycle of Lemma 3.2 by the $\mathbb{C}^*$ -action lies in the local Milnor piece and converges uniformly to p , because all cone coordinates have positive weights. Hence $g|_{\nu(s)} = g(p, 0) + o(1)$ uniformly, while homogeneity factors the same monomial $\chi(b(s))$ from the main term and the error. The global period is therefore

$$\int_{\nu(s)} \Omega_s = \chi(b(s)) (c(\nu) g(p, 0) + o(1)).$$

If $\nu \neq 0$ in $H_3(\mathcal{M}; \mathbb{Q})$ had $\nu_* = 0$ in $H_3(X_s; \mathbb{Q})$ for arbitrarily small $s \neq 0$, then a rational multiple of $\nu(s)$ would bound and the closed form Ω_s would have zero period, while $\chi(b(s)) \neq 0$ off the discriminant; letting $s \rightarrow 0$ along such values gives $c(\nu) g(p, 0) = 0$ and, since $g(p, 0) \neq 0$, $c(\nu) = 0$, contradicting the injectivity of the period pairing in Lemma 3.2. (That $H_3(\mathcal{M}; \mathbb{Q})$ has rank one is what converts this class-by-class exclusion into injectivity for all small s ; a higher-rank branch would require a uniform argument.) $\square$

4. SURGERY MEMBERSHIP

4.1. The decomposition. Let $p_1, \dots, p_r$ be the singular points of X , with disjoint closed cone neighborhoods U_p chosen inside Milnor balls, and $W = X \setminus \bigcup_p \text{int } U_p$, so $\partial W = \bigsqcup_p L_p$. Good representatives exist for arbitrary isolated singularities (Greuel [Gre20, Definition 2.12, Lemma 2.13, Theorem 2.15]), and for small s the family is smooth, hence C^∞ -trivial, over a neighborhood of W ; therefore

$$X_s \cong W \cup_{\bigsqcup L_p} \bigsqcup_p \mathcal{M}_p, \quad \widehat{X} \cong W \cup_{\bigsqcup L_p} \bigsqcup_p N_p,$$

where $\mathcal{M}_p$ is the Milnor fiber of the induced local smoothing and N_p a neighborhood of the exceptional set of the fixed crepant resolution. Both gluings are along the same links. Only the C^∞ -triviality over a neighborhood of W is used here, so the same decomposition of X_s along $\bigsqcup_p L_p$ holds for an arbitrary one-parameter deformation, with $X_s \cap U_p$ in place of $\mathcal{M}_p$ at any point whose germ is not smoothed; this is the form Section 4.3 uses.

Lemma 4.1 (membership). *For every $\gamma \in H_3(X_s; \mathbb{Q})$, the Mayer–Vietoris boundary $\partial\gamma \in \bigoplus_p H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q})$ lies in the space $K(X)$ of Theorem A: its components die in every $H_2(\mathcal{M}_p; \mathbb{Q})$, and their sum dies in $H_2(W; \mathbb{Q})$, hence in $H_2(\widehat{X}; \mathbb{Q})$. Moreover, at a node q the L_q -component of $\partial\gamma$ is a fixed nonzero multiple of $(\gamma \cdot \delta_q)$ times the generator, and at a cone point p the boundary map identifies $H_3(\mathcal{M}_p, L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{R}_p$.*

Proof. The first statement is Mayer–Vietoris exactness for $X_s = W \cup \bigsqcup \mathcal{M}_p$, together with $W \subset \widehat{X}$. At a node, $\mathcal{M} \simeq T^*S^3$: $H_3(\mathcal{M}, L; \mathbb{Q}) \cong H^3(\mathcal{M}; \mathbb{Q}) = \mathbb{Q}$ is generated by a cotangent fiber F with ∂F the S^2 -generator of $H_2(S^2 \times S^3)$ and $F \cdot \delta = 1$; excision identifies the L_q -component of $\partial\gamma$ with ∂ of the image of γ in $H_3(\mathcal{M}_q, L_q)$, which equals $(\gamma \cdot \delta_q)F$ by the perfect pairing. At a cone point, exactness of the pair sequence makes the image of $\partial: H_3(\mathcal{M}, L; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(L; \mathbb{Q})$ equal to $\ker(H_2(L; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(\mathcal{M}; \mathbb{Q})) = \mathcal{R}_p$, while Lefschetz duality gives $\dim H_3(\mathcal{M}, L; \mathbb{Q}) = b_3(\mathcal{M})$, which by Section 2.3 equals 1, 1, 2 in the three branches, the rank of $\mathcal{R}_p$ computed in Proposition 2.1. A surjection between spaces of equal finite dimension is an isomorphism, so ∂ is injective with image $\mathcal{R}_p$; equivalently $H_3(\mathcal{M}) \rightarrow H_3(\mathcal{M}, L)$ is zero, $H_3(L) \rightarrow H_3(\mathcal{M})$ is surjective, and the skew intersection form of $H_3(\mathcal{M}; \mathbb{Q})$ vanishes. $\square$

4.2. Boundary compatibility. Lemma 4.1 uses the subspaces $\mathcal{R}_p \subset H_2(L_p)$ through the *sweep-side* description of Proposition 2.1 (the unit normal circle bundle of $\bar{S} \subset V$), while the map to $H_2(\widehat{X})$ and all coordinates in Section 5 use the *resolution-side* description (the projection $L_p \rightarrow E_p$ of the cone link onto the exceptional del Pezzo, the circle-bundle projection recalled after Lemma 4.2). These are a priori different identifications of $H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q})$ with $K^\perp$, and an arbitrary boundary diffeomorphism need not preserve either marking. Their compatibility is therefore a statement, not a formality. It appears not to be available in the literature: the identification of the germ Milnor fiber with the sweep complement is standard as *open* manifolds ([PP15, Proposition 4.2]), but the manifold-with-boundary form, compatible with the canonical link identification, is what the following lemma supplies.

Lemma 4.2 (boundary compatibility). *Let (X, p) be analytically isomorphic to the anti-canonical cone over the del Pezzo surface S , smoothed by a one-parameter family through the component c with sweep $V \supset \bar{S}$. Then the boundary identification $\partial\mathcal{M}_p \cong L_p$ arising from the surgery decomposition is such that the sweep-side projection $H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(\bar{S}; \mathbb{Q})$ and the circle-bundle projection $H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(E_p; \mathbb{Q})$ agree up to an isometry of $(H_2(E_p; \mathbb{Q}), \cdot)$ carrying K to K . Consequently $\mathcal{R}_p$, read in resolution-side coordinates, is the root subspace of Proposition 2.1.*

Here the germ-local crepant resolution of $C(S)$ is the blowup of the vertex, its exceptional divisor is the zero section $E_p \cong S$ of the total space of $\mathcal{O}_S(K_S)$, the link L_p is the unit circle bundle of that line bundle, and the *circle-bundle projection* is the bundle projection $L_p \rightarrow E_p$; this is the identification used in (1).

Proof. Let $\mathcal{Y}_c \rightarrow B_c$ be the $\mathbb{C}^*$ -equivariant Altmann–Pinkham family on the reduced component c . All component parameters have weight one and all affine cone coordinates have

positive weights, so an equivariant closed embedding $\mathcal{Y}_c \hookrightarrow \mathbb{A}^N \times B_c$ with fibre coordinate weights $w_1, \dots, w_k > 0$ exists, and we let $\overline{\mathcal{Y}}_c \rightarrow B_c$ be the fibrewise closure of $\mathcal{Y}_c$ in $\mathbb{P}(1, w_1, \dots, w_k) \times B_c$. This is Pinkham's sweeping out of the cone [Pin74, (4.2), (5.1)] carried out in families over B_c : the divisor at infinity is cut by the weight-zero coordinate and is Proj of the graded coordinate ring of the cone, hence the fixed family $\bar{S} \times B_c$, independent of b because the parameters have positive weight. For b off the discriminant the pair $(\overline{\mathcal{Y}}_b, \bar{S})$ is the polarized sweep pair $(V, \bar{S})$ of Proposition 2.1, which is where its smoothness comes from. Choose an equivariant affine embedding, write $w_1, \dots, w_k > 0$ for the coordinate weights and, for a common multiple d of them, use the weighted radius

$$\rho(z) = \left(\sum_{i=1}^k |z_i|^{2d/w_i} \right)^{1/(2d)}, \quad \rho(r \cdot z) = r\rho(z) \quad (r > 0).$$

Fix a sufficiently small weighted Milnor radius ε and a small sphere of radius η in B_c . Every sufficiently small parameter $\beta \in c$ off the discriminant is uniquely $\beta = tb$ with $t > 0$ and $\|b\| = \eta$. The discriminant is homogeneous, so b is also off it. The action by t^{-1} gives a diffeomorphism of pairs

$$(3) \quad (\mathcal{Y}_\beta \cap \{\rho \leq \varepsilon\}, \mathcal{Y}_\beta \cap \{\rho = \varepsilon\}) \cong (K_{t,b}, \Sigma_{t,b}), \quad K_{t,b} := \mathcal{Y}_b \cap \{\rho \leq \varepsilon/t\}.$$

The pair on the left is the actual compact Milnor fiber and its boundary, not merely its interior.

We next identify the pair on the right with the sweep compact core. Near the fixed divisor $S \subset \overline{\mathcal{Y}}_b$, choose a normal coordinate q , and pass to the real oriented blowup along S . An affine coordinate of weight w_i has the form

$$z_i = q^{-w_i} (a_i(y, b) + O(q)),$$

where $y \in S$ and the leading coefficients do not vanish simultaneously. Consequently

$$(4) \quad \rho = |q|^{-1} A(y, \arg q, |q|, b)$$

with A smooth and strictly positive on the oriented boundary. For t small, the equation $\rho = \varepsilon/t$ therefore has a unique solution for $|q|$ and is a smooth radial graph over the unit normal circle bundle of S . Normal radial flow identifies this graph with the boundary of a fixed tube of S , preserving the projection to S , and extends across the intervening collar. Thus (3) continues to a diffeomorphism of pairs

$$(\mathcal{M}_p, \partial\mathcal{M}_p) \cong (\overline{\mathcal{Y}}_b \setminus \text{int Tube}(S), \partial\text{Tube}(S))$$

that carries the actual boundary inclusion to the tube-boundary inclusion.

By the sweep description of Section 2.3, the compactified smooth pair $(\overline{\mathcal{Y}}_b, S)$ is the corresponding polarized sweep pair $(V, \bar{S})$; along a connected smooth branch the pair identifications may be transported by Ehresmann with the trivializing vector field chosen to vanish on the fixed divisor S .

It remains to identify the marking of that boundary. Apply the same construction to the radial family $\mathcal{Y}_{\tau b}$ for $0 < \tau \leq t$. Formula (4) shows, on the real oriented blowup, that the rescaled boundary graphs extend smoothly to $\tau = 0$. Their limiting projection sends a nonzero point of the central cone to its projective class in S , while the normal circle is its S^1 -orbit. It is therefore exactly the circle-bundle projection $L_p \rightarrow S$ of the cone link.

It remains to compare this radial transport with the identification $\partial\mathcal{M}_p \cong L_p$ that Section 4.1 fixes, which is not a free choice. The two live over different parameter spaces, so name the map between them: let $\beta: (\mathbb{D}, 0) \rightarrow (B_c, 0)$ classify the induced local deformation, so that

after shrinking the local family is $\beta^*\mathcal{Y}_c$, and take the good representative U_p of Section 4.1 with ∂U_p corresponding to $\{\rho = \varepsilon\}$. The comparison is in three steps: the boundary is a locally trivial bundle over the whole base, discriminant included; two trivializations of it over the disc induce the same map on H_2 ; and the radial transport is one such trivialization.

First, $\{\rho = \varepsilon\} \cap \mathcal{Y}_b$, for $b \in B_c$, is a locally trivial C^∞ bundle over all of B_c , discriminant included. The relative singular locus is proper over the compact ball $\{\rho \leq \varepsilon\}$ and meets the central fiber only at the vertex, so for small b it stays inside $\{\rho < \varepsilon\}$; the total space is smooth near $\{\rho = \varepsilon\}$; and $\mathcal{Y}_b$ meets $\{\rho = \varepsilon\}$ transversally, which holds at $b = 0$ by $\rho(r \cdot z) = r\rho(z)$ and is open in b by compactness. Ehresmann applies.

Second, fix a trivialization T of that bundle. Then β^*T and the trivialization of Section 4.1 are two trivializations of the same bundle over $\mathbb{D}$. Two such identify a fiber with the fiber over 0 by maps differing by $g(0)^{-1}g(s)$ for some g into the diffeomorphism group of L_p ; a path from 0 to s makes $t \mapsto g(\gamma(t))$ an isotopy from $g(0)$ to $g(s)$, so the discrepancy is isotopic to the identity and acts trivially on H_2 . Only path-connectedness is used.

Third, the radial transport trivializes the same bundle over the ray through $\beta(s)$, so on that ray it agrees with T on H_2 for the same reason. The sweep-side tube projection and the resolution-side circle-bundle projection therefore induce the same map on H_2 , up to the isometry of the statement.

Finally the A_1 and A_2 summands for dP_6 and the unique (-2) -line for dP_7 are intrinsic to the polarized lattice, so they correspond. Since the displayed diffeomorphism is one of pairs, it computes the kernel of the actual inclusion $H_2(\partial\mathcal{M}_p) \rightarrow H_2(\mathcal{M}_p)$, as required. $\square$

4.3. Deformations that leave germs singular. Theorem A concerns smoothings. A threefold carrying a germ with no smoothing at all admits none, but it may still admit deformations that smooth its other germs, and the surgery argument constrains those as well. We record the form of Lemma 4.1 that Section 7 uses. Call an isolated singularity *reduced-rigid* if the reduction of its miniversal base is a single point; this does not assert $T^1 = 0$. The anticanonical cone over $\mathbb{F}_1 = \text{Bl}_1 \mathbb{P}^2$, one of the two del Pezzo surfaces of degree 8 (not $\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^1$, whose cone is smoothable), is reduced-rigid: its quadrilateral, with edge vectors $(1,0), (1,2), (-2,-1), (0,-1)$, admits no nontrivial Minkowski decomposition *into lattice polygons*, although its cone of rational Minkowski summands is two-dimensional, so that $\dim T^1 = 1$ and the miniversal base is $\text{Spec } \mathbb{C}[\varepsilon]/(\varepsilon^2)$ [Alt97, (9.1)(iv), (9.2)]; see also Gross [Gro97, Example 2.19, §5.5] and [Wue26a].

Lemma 4.3. *Let $(Y, 0)$ be reduced-rigid and let $\mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$ be a one-parameter deformation of a complex space X with $(X, p) \cong (Y, 0)$. Then the induced deformation of the germ at p is trivial. Consequently there are a neighborhood U of p in $\mathcal{X}$ and an $\varepsilon > 0$ with $U \cong V \times \mathbb{D}_\varepsilon$ over $\mathbb{D}_\varepsilon$, so that for $0 < |s| < \varepsilon$ the fiber $X_s \cap U$ has a singular point q_s , with $q_s \rightarrow p$ and $(X_s, q_s) \cong (Y, 0)$.*

Proof. Near p the family is induced from the miniversal deformation by a holomorphic map $c: (\mathbb{D}, 0) \rightarrow (B, 0)$. The analytic local ring of a disk is a domain, hence reduced, so c factors through B_{red} , a reduced point; thus c is constant, and the pullback of the miniversal family along a constant map is the product $(Y, 0) \times (\mathbb{D}, 0)$. The final statement is the passage from the germ at $(p, 0)$ to fibers, by choosing representatives of that product decomposition. $\square$

Lemma 4.4 (membership, with germs left singular). *Let X and $\hat{X}$ be as in the setting fixed in Section 1 before Theorem A, except that X may carry in addition finitely many anticanonical cones over $\mathbb{F}_1$, with an exceptional $\mathbb{F}_1$ over each of them on $\hat{X}$; no smoothing of X is assumed*

to exist. Let $\mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$ be any one-parameter deformation of X and let

$$\Sigma = \{p \in \text{Sing } X : \text{the local fiber } X_s \cap U_p \text{ is singular}\},$$

a set independent of s for small $s \neq 0$, because each local classifying arc either lies in the local discriminant or meets it only at the origin. Put

$$X_s^b = W \cup \bigsqcup_{p \notin \Sigma} \mathcal{M}_p,$$

a compact oriented 6-manifold with boundary $\bigsqcup_{p \in \Sigma} L_p$ contained in the smooth locus of X_s .

Then for every $\gamma \in H_3(X_s^b, \partial X_s^b; \mathbb{Q})$ there is a class $\kappa \in \bigoplus_p H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q})$ with

$$\kappa \in \ker \left(\bigoplus_p H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(\widehat{X}; \mathbb{Q}) \right), \quad \kappa_p \in \mathcal{R}_p \quad (p \notin \Sigma \text{ a cone point}),$$

whose component at a node $q \notin \Sigma$ is a fixed nonzero multiple of $(\gamma \cdot \delta_q)$ times the generator, and whose component at a cone point $p \notin \Sigma$ is the image of γ under the composite $H_3(X_s^b, \partial X_s^b; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_3(\mathcal{M}_p, L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \xrightarrow{\partial, \sim} \mathcal{R}_p$. Here $\gamma \cdot \delta_q$ is the Poincaré–Lefschetz pairing of X_s^b . No local condition is imposed on κ_p for $p \in \Sigma$; those coordinates are of course still coupled to the others by the displayed kernel condition.

Proof. By Lemma 4.3 every $\mathbb{F}_1$ -cone point lies in Σ , so a cone point $p \notin \Sigma$ is a dP_6 - or dP_7 -cone point and the local computations of Lemma 4.1 apply to it. Apply Mayer–Vietoris for the pair $(X_s^b, \partial X_s^b)$ with $A = W$, $B = \bigsqcup_{p \notin \Sigma} \mathcal{M}_p$ and $\partial X_s^b \subset A$, the couple being made excisive by the standard collar thickening:

$$H_3(X_s^b, \partial X_s^b; \mathbb{Q}) \xrightarrow{\partial} \bigoplus_{p \notin \Sigma} H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \longrightarrow H_2(W, \partial X_s^b; \mathbb{Q}) \oplus \bigoplus_{p \notin \Sigma} H_2(\mathcal{M}_p; \mathbb{Q}).$$

The second summand gives $(\partial\gamma)_p \in \mathcal{R}_p$ at the cone points $p \notin \Sigma$. For the first, let $x \in H_2(W; \mathbb{Q})$ be the image of $\partial\gamma$. It dies in $H_2(W, \partial X_s^b; \mathbb{Q})$, so by exactness of

$$H_2(\partial X_s^b; \mathbb{Q}) \longrightarrow H_2(W; \mathbb{Q}) \longrightarrow H_2(W, \partial X_s^b; \mathbb{Q})$$

it is the image of some $y \in H_2(\partial X_s^b; \mathbb{Q}) = \bigoplus_{p \in \Sigma} H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q})$. Set $\kappa_p = (\partial\gamma)_p$ for $p \notin \Sigma$ and $\kappa_p = -y_p$ for $p \in \Sigma$. Then κ dies in $H_2(W; \mathbb{Q})$, hence in $H_2(\widehat{X}; \mathbb{Q})$ because $W \subset \widehat{X}$.

For the local statements, fix a node $q \notin \Sigma$. Since $\partial X_s^b \subset W$ is disjoint from $\mathcal{M}_q$, excision gives a restriction $H_3(X_s^b, \partial X_s^b; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_3(\mathcal{M}_q, L_q; \mathbb{Q})$, and under Poincaré–Lefschetz duality on X_s^b it is dual to the inclusion $H_3(\mathcal{M}_q; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_3(X_s^b; \mathbb{Q})$. With $F \cdot \delta_q = 1$ as in the proof of Lemma 4.1, the restriction of γ is therefore $(\gamma \cdot \delta_q)F$, and κ_q is $(\gamma \cdot \delta_q) \partial F$. The same excision at a cone point $p \notin \Sigma$, followed by the isomorphism $\partial: H_3(\mathcal{M}_p, L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow \mathcal{R}_p$ of Lemma 4.1, gives the second statement. $\square$

Remark 4.5. The construction of Ω in Section 3.1 is unchanged in this setting. It uses the decomposition

$$X_s = W \cup \bigsqcup_{p \notin \Sigma} \mathcal{M}_p \cup \bigsqcup_{p \in \Sigma} (X_s \cap U_p)$$

along all the links, the vanishing $H^1(L_p; \mathbb{Z}) = 0$ of Section 3.1, which covers the $\mathbb{F}_1$ link, and the triviality of $\omega_{\mathcal{X}/\mathbb{D}}$ near each $(p, 0)$. The fiber X_s is allowed to be singular. That it is Gorenstein needs an argument now that it is not smooth, and the following one replaces the appeal to base change: X_0 is Gorenstein and is the divisor $\{t = 0\}$ of $\mathcal{X}$ with t a nonzerodivisor by flatness, so $\mathcal{X}$ is Gorenstein near X_0 ; each X_s is then a Cartier divisor in a Gorenstein

space and hence Gorenstein, and adjunction makes $\omega_{\mathcal{X}/\mathbb{D}}$ invertible with $\omega_{\mathcal{X}/\mathbb{D}}|_{X_s} \cong \omega_{X_s}$. The singularities of X_s are isolated for small s , since the singular locus of $\mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$ is closed, proper over $\mathbb{D}$, and meets X_0 in a finite set; the same argument places $\text{Sing } X_s$ inside $\bigsqcup_p \text{int } U_p$, which is what makes X_s^b lie in the smooth locus. Since X_s^b lies in the smooth locus of X_s , the period arguments of Lemmas 3.1 and 3.3 apply verbatim with $H_3(X_s; \mathbb{Q})$ replaced by $H_3(X_s^b; \mathbb{Q})$: requiring a bounding 4-chain to lie in X_s^b is a stronger demand than requiring it in X_s , so the nonvanishing concluded is the weaker of the two and is what Section 7 uses; the cycles involved lie in X_s^b by construction. Poincaré–Lefschetz duality on the compact oriented manifold with boundary X_s^b , which pairs $H_3(X_s^b; \mathbb{Q})$ perfectly with $H_3(X_s^b, \partial X_s^b; \mathbb{Q})$, replaces Poincaré duality on X_s .

5. THE DISTINGUISHED HYPERSURFACE AND ITS FINITE DATA

5.1. The threefold. Let $\Delta = \Delta_{\mathbb{F}_1}$ be the 22-vertex reflexive 4-polytope of [Wue26c, Theorem 6.1] and $\Delta^\vee$ its polar, with the 26 vertices $q_1, \dots, q_{26}$ listed in Table 1. The generic anticanonical hypersurface $X^\circ \subset \mathbb{P}_{\Delta^\vee}$ has, for every Batyrev-regular choice of equation, exactly 26 ordinary double points (one for each unit-square 2-face of $\Delta^\vee$), two anticanonical dP₇-cone points (the two pentagon faces with one interior point) and two dP₆-cone points (the two hexagon faces) [Wue26c, Section 6]. All thirty germs are *analytically* the cones: the ambient chart at the 3-dimensional cone over a 2-face F splits as $C(F) \times \mathbb{C}^*$, the restriction of the defining section to the one-dimensional orbit is $t^k(c_a + c_b t)$ with $c_a, c_b \neq 0$ by Batyrev regularity because the dual edge F^* has lattice length one, and Weierstrass preparation in the orbit coordinate exhibits the germ as a graph over $(C(F), 0)$. In particular each face contributes exactly one singular point, the simple zero of $c_a + c_b t$.

X° satisfies the standing hypotheses of Section 3: it is an anticanonical Cartier divisor in the Gorenstein Fano toric fourfold $P = \mathbb{P}_{\Delta^\vee}$, so $\omega_{X^\circ} \cong \mathcal{O}_{X^\circ}$ by adjunction, and $h^1(\mathcal{O}_{X^\circ}) = 0$ from the sequence $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_P(K_P) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_P \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X^\circ} \rightarrow 0$ together with $H^1(\mathcal{O}_P) = 0$ and $H^2(\mathcal{O}_P(K_P)) \cong H^2(\mathcal{O}_P)^\vee = 0$ (toric vanishing and Serre duality on the complete toric fourfold).

5.2. The resolution and the matrix. Five terms recur in what follows, and we fix them here.

A *branch* at a singular point is a reduced irreducible component of the germ’s miniversal base: a node has one, a dP₇ point one (the reduced line of Section 2.2), and a dP₆ point two, the A_1 line and the A_2 plane. A one-parameter smoothing of X induces at each point an arc

TABLE 1. The 30 lattice points of $\partial\Delta^\vee$: the vertices $q_1, \dots, q_{26}$ and the four face-interior points: q_{27}, q_{28} are the interior points of the two hexagons (below $E_{6,1}, E_{6,2}$) and q_{29}, q_{30} of the two pentagons (below $E_{7,1}, E_{7,2}$).

$q_1 = (-1, -1, -1, -1)$	$q_2 = (-1, -1, -1, 0)$	$q_3 = (-1, -1, 0, -1)$	$q_4 = (-1, -1, 0, 1)$
$q_5 = (-1, -1, 1, 0)$	$q_6 = (-1, -1, 1, 1)$	$q_7 = (-1, 0, -1, -1)$	$q_8 = (-1, 0, -1, 0)$
$q_9 = (-1, 0, 0, -1)$	$q_{10} = (-1, 0, 0, 1)$	$q_{11} = (-1, 0, 1, 0)$	$q_{12} = (-1, 0, 1, 1)$
$q_{13} = (0, -1, -1, -1)$	$q_{14} = (0, -1, -1, 0)$	$q_{15} = (0, -1, 0, 1)$	$q_{16} = (0, -1, 0, 0)$
$q_{17} = (0, 1, -1, -1)$	$q_{18} = (0, 1, -1, 0)$	$q_{19} = (0, 1, 0, -1)$	$q_{20} = (0, 1, 0, 0)$
$q_{21} = (1, 1, -1, -1)$	$q_{22} = (1, 0, -1, 0)$	$q_{23} = (0, 0, 0, -1)$	$q_{24} = (0, 0, 0, 1)$
$q_{25} = (0, 0, 1, 0)$	$q_{26} = (0, 0, 1, 1)$	$q_{27} = (-1, -1, 0, 0)$	$q_{28} = (-1, 0, 0, 0)$
$q_{29} = (0, 0, -1, -1)$	$q_{30} = (0, 0, -1, 0)$		

into one branch, and $\mathcal{R}_p$ depends on which. A *profile* for X is a choice of branch at every dP_6 point at once; the other germ types offer no choice, so X with k del Pezzo sextic points has 2^k profiles, and a criterion that must hold for every smoothing is evaluated on each.

A coordinate of $\bigoplus_p H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q})$ is *covered* when Theorem 6.1 asserts nonvanishing there: every node coordinate, the (-2) -line at every dP_7 point, and the A_1 summand at a dP_6 point on a profile that sends it to the line branch. The A_2 plane is not covered, which is the gap recorded in Section 10.1.

The *root subspace* of a cone point is $\mathcal{R}_p$ read in $K^\perp$ through Proposition 2.1: the (-2) -line at a dP_7 point, and the A_1 or the A_2 summand of $K^\perp \cong A_1 \oplus A_2$ at a dP_6 point. The name records that at degree 6 these are the root sublattices of $K^\perp$. At degree 7 the lattice $K^\perp$ has discriminant 7 and is not generated by its roots, and the subspace is the line spanned by its unique (-2) -class up to sign.

We call the rows of B at a germ its *relation rows*; Proposition 8.2 shows that their complexifications form a basis of the germ's T^1 .

Fix the crepant resolution $\hat{X} \rightarrow X^\circ$ obtained from the projective simplicial subdivision of the face fan of $\Delta^\vee$ using all thirty boundary lattice points, with the star subdivision at the four face-interior points and the twenty-six square diagonals

$$\begin{aligned} &(q_2, q_7), (q_2, q_{13}), (q_3, q_7), (q_4, q_8), (q_4, q_{14}), (q_5, q_9), (q_5, q_{13}), (q_5, q_{23}), (q_9, q_{23}), \\ &(q_6, q_{10}), (q_{10}, q_{15}), (q_6, q_{11}), (q_6, q_{16}), (q_6, q_{25}), (q_8, q_{17}), (q_9, q_{17}), (q_{12}, q_{18}), (q_{12}, q_{24}), \\ &(q_{12}, q_{19}), (q_{12}, q_{25}), (q_{14}, q_{16}), (q_{16}, q_{23}), (q_{16}, q_{26}), (q_{18}, q_{19}), (q_{20}, q_{24}), (q_{20}, q_{25}), \end{aligned}$$

labeled $N_1, \dots, N_{26}$ in this order; the subdivision is smooth and projective. Over the nodes π is small with exceptional curves Γ_i , and over the cone points the exceptional divisors are toric surfaces $E_{6,1}, E_{6,2} \cong \mathrm{dP}_6$ and $E_{7,1}, E_{7,2} \cong \mathrm{dP}_7$.

Write $\hat{\Sigma}$ for that subdivided fan and $\mathbb{P}_{\hat{\Sigma}} = \hat{X}$'s ambient fourfold $\mathrm{TV}(\hat{\Sigma})$; the letter Y stays with the cone germ of Section 2. We record the two families of functionals on $\mathrm{Pic}(\mathbb{P}_{\hat{\Sigma}})$ (equivalently, by restriction, on $\mathrm{Pic}(\hat{X}) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$, though only one containment is used below) whose kernel computation is the finite input. *Node rows*: for each square with cyclic vertices (a, b, c, d) and chosen diagonal (a, c) , the intersection functional of Γ_i , with values -1 at D_a, D_c , $+1$ at D_b, D_d and 0 otherwise; it annihilates principal divisors because $q_a + q_c = q_b + q_d$. *Divisorial rows*: for each exceptional surface, the composition of the restriction $\mathrm{Pic}(\mathbb{P}_{\hat{\Sigma}}) \rightarrow \mathrm{Pic}(E)$ ($D_j \mapsto$ the boundary curve of E for the rays of the face, $D_{\mathrm{int}} \mapsto K_E$, all other rays $\mapsto 0$) with a basis of the rank-2 or 3 lattice $K^\perp \subset \mathrm{Pic}(E)^\vee$. In the bases of Table 2 the three dP_6 functionals $\varphi_{s_1}, \varphi_{s_2}, \varphi_{s_3}$ satisfy $\varphi_{s_i}^2 = -2$, $\varphi_{s_1} \cdot \varphi_{s_2} = 1$, $\varphi_{s_3} \perp \varphi_{s_1}, \varphi_{s_2}$, so $\langle \varphi_{s_3} \rangle$ is the A_1 summand and $\langle \varphi_{s_1}, \varphi_{s_2} \rangle$ the A_2 summand; the two dP_7 functionals satisfy $\varphi_\beta^2 = -2$, $\varphi_\alpha^2 = -4$, and φ_β spans the unique (-2) -line. Stacking the 26 node rows and the ten divisorial rows gives an integral matrix $B \in \mathrm{Mat}_{36 \times 26}(\mathbb{Z})$ in the dual basis of the 26 divisor classes complementary to the unimodular cone $(q_{15}, q_{22}, q_{24}, q_{26})$.

5.3. The ambient kernel computation. Write coordinates on $\mathbb{Q}^{36}$ as

$$(u_1, \dots, u_{26}; s_1, s_2, s_3 \text{ at } E_{6,1}; s_1, s_2, s_3 \text{ at } E_{6,2}; \alpha_1, \beta_1; \alpha_2, \beta_2).$$

The labels s_1, s_2, s_3 are chosen to match those of Section 2.2: there $\{s_1 = s_2 = 0\}$ cuts out the line component of the miniversal base and $\{s_3 = 0\}$ the plane component, and here the same two equations cut out the A_1 line and the A_2 plane of $K^\perp$. These are different spaces and the coincidence of equations is a choice of labelling, not an identification. The

TABLE 2. Exceptional-surface data. Bases of $\text{Pic}(E)$: boundary divisors at the rays listed; intersection matrices I ; canonical classes K ; and the $K^\perp$ functionals in the dual bases. The two dP_6 surfaces carry identical data at rays (q_3, q_4, q_5, q_6) , resp. $(q_9, q_{10}, q_{11}, q_{12})$.

surface	lattice data	$K^\perp$ rows
$E_{6,i}$	$I_6 = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & -1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad K = (-1, -1, -2, -2)$	$\varphi_{s_1} = (0, 0, -1, 1)$ $\varphi_{s_2} = (-1, -1, 1, 0)$ $\varphi_{s_3} = (-1, 1, 1, -1)$ $\varphi_\alpha = (1, -1, 0)$
$E_{7,1}$	$I_{7,1} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & -1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$ at (q_{13}, q_{17}, q_{21}) , $K = (-1, -1, -2)$	$\varphi_\beta = (1, 1, -1)$
$E_{7,2}$	$I_{7,2} = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$ at (q_{14}, q_{18}, q_{22}) , $K = (-1, -1, -2)$	$\varphi_\alpha = (-2, 0, 1)$ $\varphi_\beta = (-1, -1, 1)$

following statements are exact integral computations from the data of Tables 1 and 2 and the subdivision of Section 5.2:

- (1) $\text{rank } B = 21$ and $\dim \ker(B^\top) = 15$; the node subsystem has rank 18, with coloops exactly N_9 and N_{11} ; the unique row coloop of the full matrix is the β_1 -row, i.e. β_1 vanishes identically on $\ker(B^\top)$. This last statement is read in the basis of Table 2: replacing φ_α by $\varphi_\alpha + c\varphi_\beta$ shears the kernel coordinates and can destroy it. What is basis-free is the restricted statement of item (2), since once $\alpha = 0$ the coordinate β does not depend on the choice of complement to the (-2) -line, and it is the restricted statement that the second proof of Theorem 6.5 uses.
- (2) On the *enlarged restricted kernel* $\ker(B^\top) \cap \{\alpha_1 = \alpha_2 = 0\}$, of dimension 13, the four coordinates $u_9, u_{11}, \beta_1, \beta_2$ vanish identically. The four finer profiles obtained by additionally restricting each dP_6 block to its A_1 line ($s_1 = s_2 = 0$) or its A_2 plane ($s_3 = 0$) have dimensions 9, 10, 10, 12 and force the same four coordinates, together with one s_3 on each mixed profile. The last dimension is 12 and not 11 because the two s_3 -coordinates are proportional on the enlarged restricted kernel: imposing either alone drops the dimension by one, and imposing the second drops it no further. That proportionality is also why a mixed profile, which deletes one s_3 , forces the other.
- (3) The forcing is critical in the dP_7 data: releasing either α -coordinate destroys it.

By construction $\ker(B^\top)$ contains the kernel of $\bigoplus_p H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q})$ written in these coordinates: the node generators map to $\pm[\Gamma_i]$ and the divisorial classes to their pushforwards from $K^\perp \subset H_2(E_p)$, and each row is the pairing with an ambient divisor class. Only this containment is used: if the ambient Picard group under-detected $H_2(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q})$, the ambient kernel would be larger than the topological one and every forced-zero statement would still bind. Equality in fact holds here ($h^{1,1}(\hat{X}) = 26$, the thirty boundary lattice points of $\Delta^\vee$ less four), and holds for every polytope in the class considered in this paper, by Proposition 8.3.

6. PROOFS OF THE MAIN RESULTS

Theorem 6.1 (mixed necessity). *Let X be a compact complex threefold with $\omega_X \cong \mathcal{O}_X$ and $h^1(\mathcal{O}_X) = 0$ whose singular points are ordinary double points and anticanonical cones over dP_6 or dP_7 , let $\hat{X} \rightarrow X$ be a crepant resolution as in Section 1, and suppose X admits a*

one-parameter smoothing. With $\mathcal{R}_p = \ker(H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(\mathcal{M}_p; \mathbb{Q}))$ for the actual Milnor fibers of the induced local smoothings, set

$$K(X) = \left\{ \kappa \in \ker \left(\bigoplus_p H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q}) \right) : \kappa_p \in \mathcal{R}_p \text{ at every cone point } p \right\}.$$

Then:

- (1) for every node q there is $\kappa \in K(X)$ with $\kappa_q \neq 0$;
- (2) for every dP_7 point q there is $\kappa \in K(X)$ whose q -component is a nonzero element of the (-2) -line $\mathcal{R}_q$;
- (3) for every dP_6 point q smoothed through the one-parameter component of its miniversal base there is $\kappa \in K(X)$ whose q -component is a nonzero element of $\mathcal{R}_q$ (the A_1 summand).

Proof. Fix small $s \neq 0$. (1) By Lemma 3.1, $\delta_q \neq 0$ in $H_3(X_s; \mathbb{Q})$; by Poincaré duality on the closed oriented X_s choose γ with $\gamma \cdot \delta_q \neq 0$; by Lemma 4.1, $\kappa = \partial\gamma$ lies in $K(X)$ and its q -component is a nonzero multiple of $\gamma \cdot \delta_q$. (2),(3) By Lemma 3.3 the generator ν of $H_3(\mathcal{M}_q; \mathbb{Q})$ survives in $H_3(X_s; \mathbb{Q})$; choose γ with $\gamma \cdot \nu_* \neq 0$; by Lemma 4.1 the q -component of $\partial\gamma$ is the image of a nonzero element of $H_3(\mathcal{M}_q, L_q; \mathbb{Q})$ under the isomorphism onto $\mathcal{R}_q$, and $\mathcal{R}_q$ is identified with the stated root subspace by Proposition 2.1, Section 2.4 and Lemma 4.2. $\square$

Remark 6.2. Since a $\mathbb{Q}$ -vector space is not the union of finitely many proper subspaces, the per-point conclusions of Theorem 6.1 combine: there is a *single* class $\kappa \in K(X)$ simultaneously nonzero at every node, every dP_7 point, and every line-smoothed dP_6 point.

Corollary 6.3. *In the purely nodal case, Theorem 6.1(1) with Remark 6.2 states: any one-parameter smoothing forces a relation among the classes $[\Gamma_i] \in H_2(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q})$ of the exceptional curves of a small resolution in which every node appears with nonzero coefficient.* $\square$

Proposition 6.4. *If X° admitted a one-parameter smoothing, the vanishing spheres of the nodes N_9 and N_{11} would satisfy $\delta_9 = \delta_{11} = 0$ in $H_3(X_s; \mathbb{Q})$.*

Proof. By Lemma 4.1 every boundary class $\partial\gamma$ lies in $K(X^\circ)$; its dP_7 -components lie on the (-2) -lines by Proposition 2.1, and Lemma 4.2 identifies these with the (-2) -lines of the resolution-side coordinates of Section 5.3, so $\partial\gamma$ lies in the enlarged restricted kernel, on which u_9 and u_{11} vanish identically (item (2) there). Since the u_q -component of $\partial\gamma$ is a nonzero multiple of $\gamma \cdot \delta_q$, nondegeneracy of the intersection pairing gives $\delta_9 = \delta_{11} = 0$. $\square$

Theorem 6.5. *X° admits no one-parameter smoothing.*

Proof. Suppose one exists. Every germ of X° is then smoothed; in particular the node N_9 is, so Lemma 3.1 gives $\delta_9 \neq 0$ in $H_3(X_s; \mathbb{Q})$, contradicting Proposition 6.4.

Alternatively, avoiding the nodes altogether: the point covered by $E_{7,1}$ is smoothed through the unique component of its miniversal base, so Theorem 6.1(2) produces $\kappa \in K(X^\circ)$ whose $E_{7,1}$ -component is a nonzero element of the (-2) -line, i.e. (Lemma 4.2 and Table 2) has nonzero β_1 -coordinate; but β_1 vanishes identically already on the unrestricted $\ker(B^\top)$ (Section 5.3, item (1)). $\square$

Remark 6.6. The two proofs are independent in the period lemma and in the fact used (Lemma 3.1 with Section 5.3(2), versus Lemma 3.3 with Section 5.3(1)), and share the membership and boundary-compatibility inputs (Lemmas 4.1 and 4.2) and the divisorial rows of Table 2.

Corollary 6.7. *Let X satisfy the standing hypotheses of Theorem 6.1 and admit no one-parameter smoothing. Then no fiber of a small representative of the miniversal deformation of X is smooth; consequently X is not smoothable over any base germ, and neither is any small deformation of X . Likewise, no formal arc in the miniversal deformation of X meets all the local smoothing loci. In particular this holds for X° , by Theorem 6.5.*

Proof. The miniversal deformation of the compact X exists [Gra74] and its discriminant is a closed analytic subset of the base. If some fiber arbitrarily close to the origin were smooth, the curve selection lemma [Mil68] would produce a real-analytic arc through the origin with smooth generic fiber; complexifying (a real-analytic function vanishing on a real segment of a disk vanishes identically, and the discriminant preimage of the complexified arc is discrete) gives a holomorphic disk, that is, a one-parameter smoothing, contrary to hypothesis. Small deformations are covered by openness of versality. For the formal statement: by Artin approximation [Art68] applied to the analytic miniversal deformation, a formal arc whose local components avoid every local discriminant would be approximated, to any jet order beyond the vanishing orders of those components, by an analytic arc with the same property. Since the singular locus of the fibers is closed in the total space and meets the central fiber only in $\text{Sing } X$, the fibers of the approximating arc are, for small t , singular at most inside the Milnor-ball neighborhoods of those points; avoidance of the local discriminants makes them smooth there, hence smooth everywhere, so the arc is a one-parameter smoothing, again contrary to hypothesis. (The local components are read through choices of local classifying maps; avoidance of the local discriminants is choice-independent, being smoothness of the local fibers.) $\square$

Remark 6.8. The two nodal coloops quantify how far X° is from the nodal theory: no relation among the twenty-six exceptional curves alone is nonzero at N_9 or N_{11} , so a smoothing would have had to route through the divisorial directions, and items (2)–(3) of Section 5.3 say the divisorial directions cannot supply what is needed at any order. The mirror partner of X° is treated in Section 7.

7. THE MIRROR PARTNER

The polytope Δ itself carries a Calabi–Yau hypersurface, the mirror partner of X° in the doubly isolated pair. Write $X_\Delta \subset \mathbb{P}_\Delta$ for a Batyrev-regular anticanonical hypersurface and $v_1, \dots, v_{22}$ for the vertices of Δ in the order of [Wue26c, Theorem 6.1], reproduced in Table 3. By that theorem X_Δ has twenty ordinary double points, one dP_6 -cone point over the hexagonal face $\text{conv}\{v_9, v_{14}, v_{15}, v_{20}, v_{21}, v_{22}\}$, and one point whose germ is the anticanonical

TABLE 3. The 24 boundary lattice points of $\Delta = \Delta_{\mathbb{F}_1}$: the vertices $v_1, \dots, v_{22}$ in the order of [Wue26c, Theorem 6.1], the interior point v_{23} of the hexagonal face and the interior point v_{24} of the $\mathbb{F}_1$ face.

$v_1 = (1, 0, 0, 0)$	$v_2 = (0, 1, 0, 0)$	$v_3 = (1, -1, 0, 0)$	$v_4 = (0, 0, 1, 0)$
$v_5 = (0, 0, 0, 1)$	$v_6 = (0, 0, 1, -1)$	$v_7 = (0, 0, -1, 1)$	$v_8 = (0, 0, 0, -1)$
$v_9 = (0, 0, -1, 0)$	$v_{10} = (-1, 1, 0, 0)$	$v_{11} = (0, -1, 0, 0)$	$v_{12} = (-1, 1, -1, 1)$
$v_{13} = (0, -1, 0, -1)$	$v_{14} = (0, -1, -1, 0)$	$v_{15} = (-1, 1, -1, 0)$	$v_{16} = (-1, 0, 0, -1)$
$v_{17} = (-1, 0, -1, 1)$	$v_{18} = (-1, -1, 0, -1)$	$v_{19} = (-2, 1, -1, 1)$	$v_{20} = (-2, 1, -1, 0)$
$v_{21} = (-1, -1, -1, 0)$	$v_{22} = (-2, 0, -1, 0)$	$v_{23} = (-1, 0, -1, 0)$	$v_{24} = (-1, 0, 0, 0)$

TABLE 4. The two exceptional surfaces of $\widehat{X}_\Delta$: the cyclic boundary rays, the intersection matrix I in the Picard basis of the boundary divisors at the rays listed, the canonical class K , and the $K^\perp$ functionals in the dual basis. As in Table 2, φ_{s_3} spans the A_1 summand and $\varphi_{s_1}, \varphi_{s_2}$ the A_2 summand, here with $\varphi_{s_1} \cdot \varphi_{s_2} = -1$. The $\mathbb{F}_1$ lattice $K^\perp$ has no (-2) -class.

surface	lattice data	$K^\perp$ rows
$E_{6,\Delta}$ over v_{23} , rays ($v_{21}, v_{14}, v_9, v_{15}, v_{20}, v_{22}$)	$I_6 = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$ at $(v_9, v_{15}, v_{20}, v_{22})$, $K = (-1, -2, -2, -1)$	$\varphi_{s_1} = (1, -1, 0, 1)$ $\varphi_{s_2} = (0, -1, 1, 0)$ $\varphi_{s_3} = (1, -1, 1, -1)$
$E_{\mathbb{F}_1}$ over v_{24} , rays ($v_{18}, v_4, v_{19}, v_{22}$)	$I_{\mathbb{F}_1} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$ at (v_{19}, v_{22}) , $K = (-3, -2)$	$\varphi_t = (-2, 3)$

cone over $\mathbb{F}_1$, over the quadrilateral face $\text{conv}\{v_4, v_{18}, v_{19}, v_{22}\}$. As in Section 5.1, X_Δ is an anticanonical Cartier divisor in a Gorenstein Fano toric fourfold, so $\omega_{X_\Delta} \cong \mathcal{O}_{X_\Delta}$ and $h^1(\mathcal{O}_{X_\Delta}) = 0$, and every germ is analytically the cone over its face because every dual edge has lattice length one. The last germ is reduced-rigid, so X_Δ admits no smoothing [Wue26a]. The reduced-rigid $\mathbb{F}_1$ germ already prevents a smoothing of X_Δ . Independently, Theorem 7.1 shows that the global obstruction is also present on X_Δ and does not use that germ.

Theorem 7.1 (necessity with germs left singular). *Let X be a compact complex threefold with $\omega_X \cong \mathcal{O}_X$ and $h^1(\mathcal{O}_X) = 0$ whose singular points are ordinary double points, anticanonical cones over dP_6 or dP_7 , and anticanonical cones over $\mathbb{F}_1$; let $\widehat{X} \rightarrow X$ be a crepant resolution as in Section 1. Let $\mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$ be any one-parameter deformation of X and let Σ be the set of points at which the nearby fiber is singular, a set containing every $\mathbb{F}_1$ -cone point by Lemma 4.3. Put*

$$K^\flat(X; \Sigma) = \left\{ \kappa \in \ker \left(\bigoplus_p H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(\widehat{X}; \mathbb{Q}) \right) : \kappa_p \in \mathcal{R}_p \text{ at every cone point } p \notin \Sigma \right\}.$$

Then $K^\flat(X; \Sigma)$ contains a class nonzero at q for every node $q \notin \Sigma$, for every dP_7 point $q \notin \Sigma$, and for every dP_6 point $q \notin \Sigma$ smoothed through the one-parameter component of its miniversal base. For $\Sigma = \emptyset$ this is Theorem 6.1.

Proof. The proof of Theorem 6.1 applies with Remark 4.5 and Lemma 4.4 in place of Lemma 4.1. At a node $q \notin \Sigma$, Lemma 3.1 gives $\delta_q \neq 0$ in $H_3(X_s^\flat; \mathbb{Q})$, since a bounding 4-chain in $X_s^\flat$ would make the period of the closed form Ω_s vanish; Poincaré–Lefschetz duality on the compact oriented manifold with boundary $X_s^\flat$ produces $\gamma \in H_3(X_s^\flat, \partial X_s^\flat; \mathbb{Q})$ with $\gamma \cdot \delta_q \neq 0$; and Lemma 4.4 converts γ into a class $\kappa \in K^\flat(X; \Sigma)$ with $\kappa_q \neq 0$. At the cone points $q \notin \Sigma$ in the two covered branches the same substitution is made in the argument of Theorem 6.1(2),(3), with Lemma 3.3 read in $H_3(X_s^\flat; \mathbb{Q})$. $\square$

Whatever the deformation and whatever Σ , the space $K^\flat(X; \Sigma)$ is by definition contained in $\ker(\bigoplus_p H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(\widehat{X}; \mathbb{Q}))$, so a coordinate that vanishes identically on the latter is forced in every case. On X_Δ that is what happens.

Fix the smooth projective crepant subdivision of the face fan of Δ that uses all twenty-four boundary lattice points, with the star subdivision at v_{23} and v_{24} and the twenty square

diagonals

$$\begin{aligned} & (v_2, v_7), (v_2, v_9), (v_3, v_8), (v_3, v_9), (v_{10}, v_{12}), (v_{10}, v_{15}), (v_{11}, v_{13}), (v_{11}, v_{14}), (v_{11}, v_{17}), \\ & (v_{10}, v_{16}), (v_9, v_{12}), (v_{12}, v_{17}), (v_{14}, v_{17}), (v_9, v_{13}), (v_{13}, v_{16}), (v_{15}, v_{16}), (v_{15}, v_{19}), (v_{14}, v_{18}), \\ & (v_{18}, v_{20}), (v_{19}, v_{21}), \end{aligned}$$

labeled $n_1, \dots, n_{20}$; the subdivision is smooth, with 94 maximal cones, and projective. The corresponding circuit relations are

$$\begin{aligned} v_1 + v_{12} &= v_2 + v_7, \quad v_1 + v_{15} = v_2 + v_9, \quad v_1 + v_{13} = v_3 + v_8, \quad v_1 + v_{14} = v_3 + v_9, \\ v_2 + v_{19} &= v_{10} + v_{12}, \quad v_2 + v_{20} = v_{10} + v_{15}, \quad v_3 + v_{18} = v_{11} + v_{13}, \quad v_3 + v_{21} = v_{11} + v_{14}, \\ v_5 + v_{21} &= v_{11} + v_{17}, \quad v_6 + v_{20} = v_{10} + v_{16}, \quad v_7 + v_{15} = v_9 + v_{12}, \quad v_7 + v_{19} = v_{12} + v_{17}, \\ v_7 + v_{21} &= v_{14} + v_{17}, \quad v_8 + v_{14} = v_9 + v_{13}, \quad v_8 + v_{18} = v_{13} + v_{16}, \quad v_8 + v_{20} = v_{15} + v_{16}, \\ v_{12} + v_{20} &= v_{15} + v_{19}, \quad v_{13} + v_{21} = v_{14} + v_{18}, \quad v_{16} + v_{22} = v_{18} + v_{20}, \quad v_{17} + v_{22} = v_{19} + v_{21}, \end{aligned}$$

in the order $n_1, \dots, n_{20}$; in each of them the right-hand pair is the chosen diagonal, so the circuit row of Section 5.2 is -1 there and $+1$ on the left-hand pair. Choosing the other diagonal negates the row and changes nothing below. Table 4 records the two exceptional surfaces. The lattice $K^\perp(\mathbb{F}_1)$ is a line spanned by a primitive class of square -8 , and it contains no (-2) -class, consistently with the reduced-rigidity of that germ. No condition is imposed at that point in any case: by Lemma 4.3 it lies in Σ for every deformation, so no Milnor fiber and no $\mathcal{R}_p$ is defined there. Stacking the twenty node rows, the three hexagon rows and the single $\mathbb{F}_1$ row gives an integral matrix $B_\Delta \in \text{Mat}_{24 \times 24}(\mathbb{Z})$, the columns being indexed by the divisors of the twenty-four boundary lattice points, which span Pic of the resolution without being a basis. The following are exact integral computations, reproduced by the ancillary programs from the printed data of Tables 3 and 4:

- (1) $\text{rank } B_\Delta = 16$ and $\dim \ker(B_\Delta^\top) = 8$; the node subsystem has rank 14, with coloops exactly n_9 and n_{10} ;
- (2) on the unrestricted kernel $\ker(B_\Delta^\top)$ the coordinates of n_9 , of n_{10} , of the $\mathbb{F}_1$ row and of the A_1 row of the hexagon vanish identically, so no branch restriction is needed;
- (3) the column of B_Δ at the divisor of v_{24} is identically zero, the node rows having no entry there and the divisorial rows having entry $\langle \varphi, K_E \rangle = 0$; the same holds at v_{23} . Discarding the $\mathbb{F}_1$ row and that column altogether leaves a system on which n_9 and n_{10} are still forced.

Theorem 7.2. *No one-parameter deformation of X_Δ has nearby fiber smooth at the node $n_9 = \text{conv}\{v_5, v_{11}, v_{17}, v_{21}\}$, and none has nearby fiber smooth at $n_{10} = \text{conv}\{v_6, v_{10}, v_{16}, v_{20}\}$. The same two conclusions hold for deformations over arbitrary analytic base germs. In particular no analytic deformation of X_Δ smooths all twenty nodes and the dP_6 point, whatever it does at the $\mathbb{F}_1$ point. By item (2) and Theorem 7.1, the same argument applied to the A_1 coordinate shows that no analytic deformation of X_Δ smooths its dP_6 point through the one-parameter component of its miniversal base. The reduced-rigidity of the $\mathbb{F}_1$ germ excludes the smoothings of X_Δ ; the deformations excluded here are ones that it leaves available.*

Proof. Suppose the nearby fiber is smooth at n_9 , so $n_9 \notin \Sigma$. By Theorem 7.1 there is $\kappa \in K^\flat(X_\Delta; \Sigma)$ with $\kappa_{n_9} \neq 0$. But $K^\flat(X_\Delta; \Sigma)$ is contained in $\ker(B_\Delta^\top)$ for every Σ , read in the coordinates above, and the n_9 coordinate vanishes identically there. The argument for n_{10} is the same.

For the dP_6 assertion, suppose first that the base is a disk and that the local classifying arc lies in the one-parameter component of the miniversal base. Theorem 7.1 then gives a class whose A_1 coordinate is nonzero, contrary to item (2).

Now let the deformation have an arbitrary analytic base germ $(S, 0)$. Since the assertions concern actual nearby fibers, we may replace S by S_{red} . If one of the excluded local smoothings occurred arbitrarily close to the origin, the curve-selection argument used in Corollary 6.7, applied to the complement of the inverse image of the relevant local discriminant, would give a holomorphic disk through the origin whose punctured fibers have the same local smoothing property. For the dP_6 assertion, apply curve selection inside the inverse image of the one-parameter component and outside its discriminant. Pullback to the resulting disk contradicts the one-parameter conclusions just proved. $\square$

Corollary 7.3. *Both members of the unique doubly isolated mixed mirror pair carry the obstruction of this paper: on X° , in the form of Theorem 6.1, it excludes every smoothing; on X_Δ , in the form of Theorem 7.1, it excludes every analytic deformation smoothing n_9 or n_{10} . On X_Δ the two mechanisms are independent: by item (3) the forcing is computed from the twenty nodes and the hexagon alone, with the $\mathbb{F}_1$ data discarded, whereas the reduced-rigidity of that germ is a statement about it alone.*

8. WHAT THE CRITERION MEASURES

The rows of Section 5.2 were introduced as a device: the $K^\perp$ functionals stand in for the exceptional curve class that a del Pezzo cone point does not have. This section identifies their span with a rational form of the germ's T^1 . It also makes the finite test of Section 9 readable and locates the criterion against the smoothing theorems of Gross [Gro97].

8.1. The combinatorial setting. Throughout this section and the next, $\Pi \subset N_{\mathbb{R}} \cong \mathbb{R}^4$ is a reflexive 4-polytope with polar Π^* , $\mathbb{P}_\Pi$ is the Gorenstein Fano toric fourfold of its face fan, and $X \subset \mathbb{P}_\Pi$ is an anticanonical hypersurface regular in Batyrev's sense [Bat94, Definition 3.1.1]. (The letter Δ stays reserved for the fixed $\Delta_{\mathbb{F}_1}$ of Section 5.1; the polytope relevant to X° is $\Pi = \Delta^\vee$, and the polytope relevant to X_Δ is $\Pi = \Delta$.)

For a 2-face G of Π with dual edge $G^* \subset \Pi^*$ of lattice length $\ell(G^*)$, the hypersurface meets the closed orbit of $\mathrm{Cone}(G)$ in $\ell(G^*)$ points, and at each of them the germ of X is the affine toric threefold of $\mathrm{Cone}(G)$, exactly as in Section 5.1 [Bat94, Wue26c]. The germ is singular unless G is a unimodular triangle, and it is isolated when every edge of G has lattice length one; we call such a G a *singular 2-face* and write $(Y_G, 0)$ for the germ. A unit square gives a node; a pentagon with one interior lattice point gives $C(\mathrm{dP}_7)$ and a hexagon with one interior lattice point gives $C(\mathrm{dP}_6)$, the interior point being the origin of the fan of the exceptional surface in each case.

Definition 8.1. Π is *admissible* if every edge of Π has lattice length one; every 2-face of Π has either three vertices and no interior lattice point, or four vertices and no interior lattice point, or five or six vertices and exactly one interior lattice point; and $\ell(G^*) = 1$ for every singular 2-face G .

The four types are the unimodular triangle, the unit square, the pentagon and the hexagon listed above: with unit edges, a quadrilateral without interior points has normalized area 2 by Pick's formula and so is a unimodular parallelogram. Note that a quadrilateral with unit edges and *one* interior point is a different face, giving a cone point over a smooth toric del Pezzo surface of degree 8, either $\mathbb{F}_1$ or $\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^1$; both are excluded here, and the $\mathbb{F}_1$ case is the one that occurs on Δ and is treated in Section 7.

For admissible Π the hypersurface X satisfies the standing hypotheses of Theorem 6.1, by the argument of Section 5.1: $\text{Sing } X$ is finite with one point per singular 2-face, and every germ is a node or an anticanonical dP_6 or dP_7 cone. The polytope $\Delta^\vee$ of Section 5.1 is admissible, its 68 two-faces being 38 unimodular triangles, 26 unit squares, two pentagons and two hexagons; Δ_{19} and Δ_{20} of Section 9 are admissible; Δ itself is not, because the quadrilateral face carrying its $\mathbb{F}_1$ -cone point is neither a square nor a triangle, but it satisfies the weaker hypothesis of Proposition 8.3 below.

8.2. The relation rows are the germ's T^1 .

Proposition 8.2. *Let G be a singular 2-face of Π with vertices $v_1, \dots, v_n$ in cyclic order, and put*

$$R_G := \left\{ a \in \mathbb{Q}^n : \sum_j a_j v_j = 0 \right\}.$$

Then R_G has dimension $n - 3$, Altmann's model gives a natural isomorphism

$$T_{(Y_G, 0)}^1 \cong R_G \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{C},$$

and the rows of Section 5.2 at G , read in the coordinates of the rays of G , form a $\mathbb{Q}$ -basis of R_G . When G is a pentagon or hexagon, so that the crepant resolution has an exceptional surface E over the germ, R_G is $K_{\mathbb{Q}}^\perp \subset \text{Pic}(E)_{\mathbb{Q}}^\vee$; when G is a unit square it is the line spanned by the intersection vector of the exceptional curve of a small resolution.

Proof. Altmann computes T^1 of the germ, concentrated in the Gorenstein degree, as the complex vector space of dilations of the edges of G satisfying the closing condition, modulo the homothety [Alt95, (6.5) and the subsequent Remark]; its dimension is $(n - 2) - 1$. Send a dilation t , with t_j the dilation of the edge (v_j, v_{j+1}) , to its jump $a_j := t_j - t_{j-1}$ across the vertex v_j . Then

$$\sum_j a_j v_j = \sum_j t_j v_j - \sum_j t_j v_{j+1} = - \sum_j t_j (v_{j+1} - v_j) = 0$$

by the closing condition; the kernel of $t \mapsto a$ is the constants. The construction is defined over $\mathbb{Q}$, and its rational form maps isomorphically to R_G : both spaces have dimension $n - 3$ because $\text{Cone}(G)$ is three-dimensional. Extending scalars gives the stated isomorphism with T^1 . For the last two clauses, note first that G lies in the affine hyperplane $\langle u_F, \cdot \rangle = -1$ for either facet $F \supset G$, so $\sum_j a_j v_j = 0$ forces $\sum_j a_j = 0$. If G is a pentagon or hexagon, the v_j are the rays of the fan of E seen from the interior lattice point, and dualizing $0 \rightarrow M_E \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}^n \rightarrow \text{Pic}(E)_{\mathbb{Q}} \rightarrow 0$ identifies $\{a : \sum_j a_j v_j = 0 \text{ in the plane of } G\}$ with $\text{Pic}(E)_{\mathbb{Q}}^\vee$; since $K_E = -\sum_j D_j$ the extra condition $\sum_j a_j = 0$ is orthogonality to K_E , and a divisorial row of Section 5.2 is $\varphi \mapsto (\langle \varphi, D_j \rangle)_j$ for φ in a basis of $K^\perp$, which is that identification. If G is a unit square with cyclic vertices (a, b, c, d) , the space is one-dimensional and spanned by $(-1, 1, -1, 1)$, because $v_a + v_c = v_b + v_d$; that is the node row of Section 5.2, the intersection functional of Γ . $\square$

Thus the $K^\perp$ lattice introduced in Section 5.2 as a substitute for the missing exceptional curve class is a natural rational form of the tangent space to the germ's deformation functor. A linear relation among the rays of a cone is the combinatorial avatar of a curve class, with a_j the intersection number against the invariant divisor D_j ; at a node the square's relation $v_a + v_c = v_b + v_d$ is the class of the exceptional curve of a small resolution, and the row $(-1, 1, -1, 1)$ of Section 5.2 is its vector of intersection numbers. The proposition says that this reading survives at a del Pezzo cone point, where the curve is not there to be read. Two

consequences follow. The interior lattice point of a pentagon or hexagon carries coefficient $\langle \varphi, K \rangle = 0$ in every row, so the rows are supported on the vertices of the face; and the total number of relation rows equals $\dim H^0(\mathcal{T}_X^1)$, which is 36 for X° and 16 for X_{19} .

8.3. The ambient kernel is the topological kernel.

Proposition 8.3. *Suppose every 2-face of Π is either a unimodular triangle or has dual edge of lattice length one; admissible polytopes, and also Δ itself, satisfy this. Write $\ell^*(G)$ for the number of lattice points in the relative interior of G , and $\ell(G^*)$ for the lattice length of the dual edge. Then the correction term $\sum_G \ell^*(G)(\ell(G^*) - 1)$, summed over 2-faces G of Π , in Batyrev’s formula [Bat94, Corollary 4.5.1] for $h^{1,1}$ vanishes. Consequently $h^{1,1}(\hat{X})$ is purely toric, the ambient divisor classes span $H^{1,1}(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q})$, and the ambient kernel $\ker(B^\top)$ of Section 5.3 is equal to, not merely contains, $\ker(\bigoplus_p H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H_2(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q}))$.*

Proof. The spanning statement is not the vanishing restated; what connects them is the proof of [Bat94, Theorem 4.4.2], where the components of $D_\rho \cap \hat{X}$ over a 2-face G are counted by $\ell^*(G)\ell^*(G^*)$. When that count vanishes each such intersection is irreducible, so the classes coming from the ambient torus-invariant divisors exhaust $H^{1,1}(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q})$. We use also $h^{2,0}(\hat{X}) = 0$, which holds since $\hat{X}$ is crepant over a Calabi–Yau with rational singularities. Granting these:

A singular 2-face has $\ell(G^*) = 1$ by hypothesis, so its factor $\ell(G^*) - 1$ vanishes; a non-singular 2-face is a unimodular triangle, so its factor $\ell^*(G)$ vanishes. Every term dies for one of the two reasons. For the last clause, a row of B records the pairings of a class with the ambient divisors, so a combination of rows vanishes exactly when the corresponding total class pairs to zero against every ambient divisor. Since $h^{2,0}(\hat{X}) = 0$ we have $H^2(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q}) = H^{1,1}(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q})$, so the Poincaré pairing $H_2 \times H^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}$ is perfect; the ambient divisor classes span $H^{1,1}$ by the first part, and therefore the total class pairs to zero against all of them exactly when it vanishes in $H_2(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q})$. $\square$

Section 5.3 uses only the containment, which is the safe direction for a necessity statement: an ambient kernel larger than the topological one makes every forced-zero conclusion stronger. The proposition upgrades it to equality for the whole class at once, which matters in the converse direction, where the containment runs the wrong way and a sufficiency statement phrased in terms of the computable test would otherwise not be well posed; that is taken up in the companion paper [Wue26d]. Note that this vanishing is not the one that empties Mavlyutov’s mechanism of non-polynomial deformations [Mav04]: that is the mirror correction, summed over 2-faces of Π^* , and it follows from the unit edges of Π . Both hold here, for related but distinct reasons.

8.4. $\mathbb{Q}$ -factoriality, and what the kernel is a defect of. Gross classifies the contractions of a smooth Calabi–Yau threefold that cannot be factored, and proves that a primitive contraction of a divisor to a point has smoothable target unless the exceptional divisor is $\mathbb{P}^2$ or $\mathbb{F}_1$ [Gro97, Theorem 5.8]; degrees 6 and 7 are allowed. This appears to collide with Theorem 6.1, which at a threefold with a single del Pezzo cone point has nothing for a relation to cancel against and so forbids a smoothing. It does not collide, and the reason identifies what the kernel measures.

Proposition 8.4. *Let X be $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial and let $\pi: \hat{X} \rightarrow X$ be a projective crepant resolution. Suppose every irreducible component E_i of $\text{Exc}(\pi)$ is contracted to a point and the points $\pi(E_i)$*

are pairwise distinct. Then the rows of Section 5.2 at each of the corresponding divisorial germs vanish identically.

Proof. Because X is $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial and π is projective and birational, the exceptional locus of π has pure codimension one [KM98, Cor. 2.63]. Thus its irreducible components $E_1, \dots, E_r$ are divisors. By hypothesis they lie over distinct points, as they do for the divisorial germs of this paper.

$\mathbb{Q}$ -factoriality also makes π^* defined on $\mathrm{Cl}(X)_{\mathbb{Q}}$, and then $\mathrm{Cl}(\hat{X})_{\mathbb{Q}} = \pi^* \mathrm{Cl}(X)_{\mathbb{Q}} \oplus \bigoplus_i \mathbb{Q}E_i$, with $\mathrm{Cl}(\hat{X}) = \mathrm{Pic}(\hat{X})$ since $\hat{X}$ is smooth. Fix i and write $E = E_i$. A pullback π^*D restricts trivially to E because $\pi(E)$ is a point, and $E_j|_E = 0$ for $j \neq i$ because E_j and E lie over distinct points, so the image of $\mathrm{Pic}(\hat{X})_{\mathbb{Q}} \rightarrow \mathrm{Pic}(E)_{\mathbb{Q}}$ is spanned by $E|_E$. That class is K_E : adjunction gives $K_E = (K_{\hat{X}} + E)|_E$, and $K_{\hat{X}}|_E = (\pi^*K_X)|_E = 0$ by crepancy and the same observation. Every divisor class therefore pairs to zero against $K_E^\perp$, and the rows, which are those pairings, vanish. $\square$

In the $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial case, then, the rows at every divisorial germ are zero, the kernel there is all of $K^\perp$, and the test of Section 9 is silent, as it must be, since [Gro97, Theorem 5.8] produces a smoothing. The proposition also says that a $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial X admits no *projective* crepant resolution with an exceptional curve; it does not say that X has no nodes, and indeed a general one-nodal quintic threefold is factorial. Contrapositively:

Corollary 8.5. *If the block of rows at a divisorial germ has positive rank, then X is not $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial. Since primitivity in [Gro97, Theorem 5.8] supplies $\mathbb{Q}$ -factoriality of the target, that theorem is silent on every X carrying such a germ, and the two statements never disagree. $\square$*

The condition in Proposition 8.4 and its contrapositive are *global*: $\mathbb{Q}$ -factoriality of X , in the sense $\mathrm{rank}(\mathrm{Cl}(X)/\mathrm{Pic}(X)) = 0$, and not the condition that a germ be $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial in its own right. The distinction is not idle. The germs here are never locally $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial: at a cone over a del Pezzo surface E the local class group is $\mathrm{Pic}(E)/\mathbb{Z}K_E$, of rank $\rho(E) - 1$, which is Namikawa's invariant σ [Nam97]. For the toric del Pezzos of the framework that rank is also $\dim T^1$ (Section 8.2), the two agreeing because Namikawa's other invariant μ vanishes on a toric germ; for a non-toric cone they differ. A threefold can carry a germ that is not locally $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial and still be globally $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial: the target of a primitive type II contraction is the example that matters here, and a general one-nodal quintic is the familiar one.

Thus a positive block rank witnesses the failure of $\mathbb{Q}$ -factoriality; it serves as a defect test, whereas the relation kernel measures cancellation among the local classes. The two quantities are not interchangeable: on X_7 the block rank is 2 while the relation kernel is zero. On X° every block has the maximal rank, 2 at each dP_7 point and 3 at each dP_6 point.

Within the admissible framework the witness never fires negatively, and this is a theorem rather than an observation. The exceptional divisor E over a singular 2-face is a toric surface whose boundary divisors are the restrictions of the ambient toric divisors, so $\mathrm{Pic}(\mathbb{P}_{\hat{\Sigma}})_{\mathbb{Q}} \rightarrow \mathrm{Pic}(E)_{\mathbb{Q}}$ is surjective and the block at that germ has the full rank $n - 3$ of Proposition 8.2, which is 2 at a pentagon and 3 at a hexagon. Since $n - 3 > 0$ at every singular 2-face, no admissible X carrying one is $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial; the argument is about the divisorial germs, a node contributing no exceptional divisor to which it could be applied. The census bears this out at every one of the 77 polytopes of Proposition 9.2 and at Δ_{19} , Δ_{20} and X° , but it is not the evidence for it. Proposition 8.4 therefore functions here as a consistency check against [Gro97, Theorem 5.8] rather than as a discriminating invariant. In the purely nodal case the defect is exactly what Friedman's criterion is about, and a $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial nodal threefold has no

small projective resolution and no relation to exploit; the generic one-nodal quintic, where the exceptional curve class dies in H_2 of the small resolution, is the standard example, and the test is silent on it (Section 9). The mixed criterion inherits that shape, with $K^\perp$ in place of the curve class.

9. THE CRITERION AS A FINITE TEST, AND AN OPEN PROBLEM

9.1. The test. Theorem 6.1 is a finite test for any concrete candidate: compute the matrix of Section 5.2 from the polytope (node rows; $K^\perp$ bases of the star fans of the pentagon and hexagon faces), restrict to the branch subspaces, and check whether a coordinate required to be nonzero by Theorem 6.1 is forced to vanish. A forced node coordinate contradicts Lemma 3.1; a forced dP_7 root coordinate contradicts Lemma 3.3; a forced s_3 -coordinate contradicts Lemma 3.3 on profiles through the line component. The test uses nothing about the example beyond Batyrev regularity and its face inventory.

Applied across the admissible polytopes of Definition 8.1 the test has a wide range, and the two ends of that range are worth separating. At the small end it is nearly immediate: with a single germ the criterion asks only whether the germ's root subspace survives in $H_2(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q})$, which is a two-row rank computation. That case is Section 9.2, and Section 9.3 shows it is not isolated: among admissible polytopes with at most nine vertices carrying a pentagonal 2-face, seventy-six of seventy-seven are obstructed, sixty-seven of them with one singular point. The interest of X° is that it is at the other end: thirty germs of three kinds, both dP_6 branch profiles, and a 36×26 matrix of rank 21 whose 15-dimensional kernel forces nothing at a node, and where the four coordinates that decide the question appear once the dP_7 branch restriction is imposed. Sections 9.4 and 9.5 sit between the two, one where the obstruction is carried entirely by the divisorial direction and one where the test is silent.

9.2. A one-germ illustration. With one singular point, the criterion reduces to whether the local root line survives in the homology of the crepant resolution.

Corollary 9.1. *Let X be as in Theorem 6.1 with exactly one singular point p , an anticanonical dP_7 cone, and suppose the (-2) -line $\mathcal{R}_p \subset H_2(L_p; \mathbb{Q})$ maps injectively into $H_2(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q})$. Then X admits no one-parameter smoothing.*

Proof. With one singular point $K(X) = \{\kappa \in \mathcal{R}_p : \kappa \mapsto 0 \text{ in } H_2(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q})\}$, which is 0 by hypothesis. A one-parameter smoothing would produce, by Theorem 6.1(2), a $\kappa \in K(X)$ whose p -component is a nonzero element of $\mathcal{R}_p$. $\square$

The hypothesis is a finite check: it suffices, and this is the safe direction of the containment used throughout Section 5.3, that the (-2) -row of Section 5.2 be nonzero, since a class pairing nontrivially with an ambient divisor does not die in $H_2(\hat{X}; \mathbb{Q})$.

Such an X exists at the seven-vertex bottom of the pentagonal census. Let

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta_7 = \operatorname{conv}\{ & (1, 0, 0, 0), (0, 1, 0, 0), (0, 0, 1, 0), (-6, -4, -1, 0), \\ & (0, 0, 0, 1), (-6, -4, 0, -1), (-3, -2, 1, -1) \}, \end{aligned}$$

reflexive with seven vertices, seven facets and sixteen edges, all of lattice length one. Of its sixteen 2-faces, fifteen are unimodular triangles and one is a pentagon with a single interior lattice point and dual edge of lattice length one, so Δ_7 is admissible and $X_7 \subset \mathbb{P}_{\Delta_7}$ has *exactly one* singular point, an anticanonical dP_7 cone, which is smoothable as a germ. As in Section 5.1, $\omega_{X_7} \cong \mathcal{O}_{X_7}$ and $h^1(\mathcal{O}_{X_7}) = 0$, and $\hat{X}_7$ has $h^{1,1} = 4$ and $h^{2,1} = 214$. The two

divisorial rows are linearly independent, so the relation-row block has rank 2, the maximum, the ambient kernel is zero, and Corollary 9.1 applies: X_7 admits no one-parameter smoothing.

Since the block has positive rank, Corollary 8.5 says X_7 is not $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial, so [Gro97, Theorem 5.8] does not speak to it and there is no conflict with the smoothability of primitive type II contractions with dP_7 exceptional divisor. And X_7 illustrates the criterion without testing it: no cancellation occurs, no branch profile is consulted beyond discarding α , and both divisorial rows do all the work.

9.3. A census of the admissible polytopes with a pentagonal 2-face, at up to nine vertices. As a bounded computational application, the test can be applied to every polytope in a finite part of the Kreuzer–Skarke classification.

Proposition 9.2. *Among the 3 905 789 reflexive 4-polytopes with at most nine vertices in the Kreuzer–Skarke classification [KS00], a count read from the published database rather than from [KS00] itself, exactly 77 are admissible and carry a pentagonal 2-face, one pentagon apiece: one at seven vertices, thirteen at eight, sixty-three at nine. No pentagonal 2-face occurs below seven vertices. None of the 77 carries a hexagonal 2-face, so each of the corresponding X has exactly one dP_7 cone point and no dP_6 point; the search records that each has at most two nodes, the inventories being 67 with the cone point alone, 9 with one node in addition, and 1 with two nodes. The test of Theorem 6.1 obstructs all but one of them, so those 76 admit no one-parameter smoothing, and by Corollary 6.7 they are not smoothable over any base germ. On the remaining polytope, which has nine vertices and two nodes, the test is silent.*

Proof. Each such X satisfies the standing hypotheses of Theorem 6.1 by Section 8.1, with a crepant resolution obtained by restricting a maximal projective crepant partial desingularization of $\mathbb{P}_{\Pi}$ [Bat94, §2.2]: small over the nodes, with exceptional divisor dP_7 over the cone point. The verdicts are the outcome of the test of Section 9.1, recomputed for each of the 77 from its vertex list (Appendix A). Since no dP_6 point occurs, the only branch restriction is $\alpha = 0$ at the pentagon, and a forced node or (-2) -coordinate is contradicted by Lemma 3.1 or Lemma 3.3. $\square$

The enumeration itself is the admissibility-restricted extract of a sweep reported in the companion paper [Wue26d]; the germ inventory, the matrix and the verdict are recomputed here from each stored vertex list. The 67 single-germ cases are instances of Corollary 9.1, and the 9 cases with one node in addition are barely more than instances of it. The reason so many fire is structural rather than accidental: the criterion detects a failure of cancellation, and with one or two germs there is almost nothing available to cancel. Section 6 exhibits one non-smoothable Calabi–Yau threefold by hand; the same criterion run mechanically over this range produces seventy-six more, none of them X° , X_{20} or X_{19} , whose polytopes have 26, 20 and 19 vertices and lie outside it.

Among the 77, the single silent polytope is the only one where the converse question can be posed, which is why the range is swept and not only counted. That case is settled in [Wue26d]; nothing in this paper depends on how.

The census is restricted to polytopes with a pentagonal 2-face, and that restriction is not vacuous: admissible polytopes in the same range carry hexagonal 2-faces, hence dP_6 cone points. For example, an eight-vertex case is obtained from Δ_7 by adjoining $(-3, -2, -1, 1)$. On such an X Theorem 6.1 constrains the one-parameter dP_6 branch and says nothing about the A_2 branch, so the verdicts above do not extend to them and we do not claim them.

9.4. An obstruction the nodal theory cannot see. The test also obstructs threefolds that no purely nodal argument can reach. Let Δ_{20} be the 20-vertex reflexive polytope

$$\begin{aligned} \text{conv}\{ & (1, 0, 0, 0), (0, 1, 0, 0), (0, 0, 1, 0), (0, 0, 0, 1), (1, -1, -1, -1), (-1, 1, 1, 1), (0, 0, 0, -1), \\ & (0, 0, -1, 0), (0, -1, 0, 0), (-1, 1, 0, 1), (0, 0, -1, -1), (-1, 1, 0, 0), (-1, 0, 1, 1), (0, -1, 0, -1), \\ & (-1, 0, 1, 0), (0, -1, -1, -1), (-1, 0, 0, 1), (-1, 0, -1, 0), (-1, -1, 0, 0), (-1, -1, 1, 0)\}, \end{aligned}$$

one of the both-sides-unit polytopes of [Wue26c]. Its generic anticanonical hypersurface X_{20} has seventeen ordinary double points and one dP_7 -cone point, all isolated; as in Section 5.1 it satisfies $\omega_{X_{20}} \cong \mathcal{O}_{X_{20}}$ and $h^1(\mathcal{O}_{X_{20}}) = 0$, and a smooth projective crepant subdivision exists, obtained as in Section 5.2 from the seventeen square diagonals and the star subdivision at the interior point of the pentagon. Here Δ_{20} has 22 lattice points and no facet with an interior point, so Batyrev's formulas give $h^{1,1}(\widehat{X}_{20}) = 22 - 5 = 17 = \text{rank Pic}$ of the ambient toric fourfold: the ambient divisor classes span $H^2(\widehat{X}_{20}; \mathbb{Q})$, and the ambient kernel of Section 5.3 coincides with the topological one rather than merely containing it, as Proposition 8.3 also gives. The outcome is:

- (1) the nodal subsystem has rank 11 of 17 and *no coloop*, so, the two kernels agreeing, every exceptional curve of a small resolution does appear with nonzero coefficient in some relation among them: Friedman's necessary condition is satisfied;
- (2) the mixed matrix has 19 rows on 21 rays, its kernel has dimension 6, and *both* dP_7 coordinates vanish identically on it, the root coordinate among them.

By Theorem 6.1(2) and Lemma 3.3, X_{20} admits no one-parameter smoothing. Here the obstruction is carried entirely by the divisorial direction, and a reader applying [Fri86, RT09] alone would find nothing wrong. On X° , by contrast, the two nodal coloops already signal that the nodal theory is insufficient.

9.5. Where the test is silent. We also ran the test on the anticanonical hypersurface X_{19} of the 19-vertex reflexive polytope Δ_{19} , whose generic member has fourteen nodes and one dP_7 -cone point, all isolated. Since this is the case the paper leaves open, we print the polytope rather than cite it: the vertices of $\Delta_{19} \subset N \cong \mathbb{Z}^4$ are

$$\begin{aligned} & (1, 0, 0, 0), \quad (0, 1, 0, 0), \quad (0, 0, 1, 0), \quad (0, 0, -1, 0), \\ & (0, -1, 0, 0), \quad (1, -1, -1, 0), \quad (0, 0, 0, 1), \quad (-1, 1, 1, -1), \\ & (0, -1, 0, 1), \quad (0, 0, -1, 1), \quad (-1, 1, 0, -1), \quad (-1, 0, 1, -1), \\ & (-1, 0, 1, 0), \quad (-1, 1, 0, 0), \quad (0, -1, -1, 0), \quad (0, -1, -1, 1), \\ & (-1, 0, 0, -1), \quad (-2, 1, 1, -1), \quad (-1, 0, 0, 1). \end{aligned}$$

It is the polytope of [Wue26c, Section 5.3]. The outcome is structurally opposite to X° :

- (1) the node subsystem has rank 12 with two coloops: as for X° , no purely nodal mechanism can smooth X_{19} ;
- (2) on the full kernel (dimension 3) the complementary dP_7 -coordinate α is already forced to zero, so every relation class lies on the (-2) -line without imposing the branch restriction; and
- (3) no coordinate required by Theorem 6.1 is forced to vanish: a generic kernel class is nonzero in all fourteen node coordinates and in the (-2) -coordinate simultaneously.

The necessity theory of this paper is therefore silent on X_{19} , which motivates Question 1.3. As a control in the opposite direction, the test applied to the generic one-nodal quintic threefold is silent as well, as it must be: there the exceptional curve class vanishes in H_2 of the small resolution (the threefold is $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial), the kernel is the whole line $H_2(L; \mathbb{Q})$, and

the node coordinate is realized, the smoothable side of the nodal picture. A smoothing of X_{19} , if it exists, must recruit the dP_7 direction; the natural construction tools are ambient toric degenerations in the sense of Ilten–Vollmert [IV12], and that is where the companion paper [Wue26d] takes the question up.

10. DISCUSSION

10.1. The two-parameter degree-6 smoothing component. Theorem 6.1 covers dP_6 points smoothed through the one-parameter component. For the two-parameter (plane) component the Milnor fiber has $b_3 = 2$, and the argument of Lemma 3.3 reduces the analogous nonvanishing to the $\mathbb{Q}$ -linear independence of two periods of $\Omega_{\mathcal{M}}$ on $W_6 \setminus \tilde{S}$, a finer question than nonvanishing, which the toric method above does not decide. None of the results of this paper require it.

10.2. First-order theory. The tangent-level analogue of the test of Section 5.3 should identify $\ker(B^\top)$ with the image of the localization map on first-order deformations, through the local-to-global comparison of Friedman–Laza [FL25, FL24]; we do not prove this, and nothing below depends on it. From that viewpoint the content of this paper is that the first-order forced-zero statements persist at every order of contact, which no first-order argument can deliver. The necessity statements of [Fri86, RT09] are of first-order type, with the upgrade to actual smoothings supplied in the nodal case by unobstructedness; the present method needs neither, which is what allows it to reach the non-lci cone points.

10.3. Sufficiency. The converse direction, constructing mixed smoothings when the test is silent, is open even for X_{19} . The purely nodal comparison is instructive: in dimension three the converse of Friedman’s criterion holds for projective nodal Calabi–Yau threefolds, by the first-order relation together with the unobstructedness theorems of Kawamata and Tian, while in higher odd dimensions Rollenske and Thomas prove a converse for nodal hypersurfaces in projective space and explain why a general converse should not be expected [RT09, Section 5]. We record one structural observation from the toric side: for a face F with $\ell(F^*) = 1$ the polar vertices adjacent to F give ambient deformation degrees whose slice polytopes admit no nontrivial Minkowski decomposition, so any ambient construction must use degrees on the extension of the dual edge, the exact combinatorial locus of Altmann’s local smoothing parameter. The companion paper [Wue26d] pursues that line.

Proposition 8.3 is what would make a converse statable in terms of the computable test: for necessity the containment $K(X) \subseteq \ker(B^\top)$ suffices and runs the right way, whereas a sufficiency statement asserting that silence of the test implies smoothability needs the two kernels to agree. On the admissible class they do. Proposition 8.2 says what such a converse would have to produce: an element of $\bigoplus_p T_{X,p}^1$, lying in the smoothing locus at each germ, whose total ray relation vanishes. Whether that is enough is exactly the question left open here.

The two directions stop for different reasons, and the reasons are structural. The necessity argument of this paper is topological: it integrates the holomorphic 3-form over vanishing cycles and never touches deformation theory, which is why the hypotheses that constrain the deformation-theoretic literature do not constrain it. A sufficiency argument has to produce a family, and every route to one in the literature carries a hypothesis that the admissible class fails.

There are two such routes and they fail differently. The Hodge-theoretic route of Friedman–Laza produces a first order smoothing and then upgrades it by assuming $\text{Def}(X)$ unobstructed, and their unobstructedness inputs, including Friedman’s recent extension to isolated Du Bois singularities, require the singularities to be local complete intersections; a cone over a del Pezzo surface of degree $d > 4$ is never one, the anticanonical model requiring more quadrics than its codimension allows [Fri25]; see also [Gro97, (3.3)]. The other route does reach non-lci germs: [Gro97, Theorem 5.8] smooths the target of a primitive type II contraction, and [Nam97, Corollary 6] shows that a $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial Calabi–Yau threefold with isolated toric Gorenstein singularities has surjective localization map, hence is smoothable when its germs are. Both require $\mathbb{Q}$ -factoriality of the target, primitivity supplying it in the first case, and Section 8.4 shows that an admissible member carrying a cone point is not $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial.

So the gap is not that no non-lci theorem exists. It is that the available non-lci theorems are exactly the ones this class escapes. Either route could be closed. The first needs an unobstructedness statement for isolated canonical Gorenstein singularities that are not complete intersections, which lies beyond the open problems listed in [FL25, Summary and Outlook]; those stop at the local complete intersection case. The second needs the $\mathbb{Q}$ -factoriality hypothesis weakened, and Section 8.4 shows that is not a technicality here: every cone-point block in the admissible class witnesses its failure.

APPENDIX A. COMPUTATIONAL CERTIFICATES

The exact lattice and matrix claims used in the proofs are reproduced by the Python programs listed below, in exact rational arithmetic and independently of any computer-algebra system. A third self-contained program combines exact integral checks with a floating-point diagnostic of the period parametrization, whose underlying identity is proved exactly in Lemma 3.2. The inputs are Tables 1 and 2, the ancillary subdivision and restriction data documents, the polytope of [Wue26c, Section 5.3], and the vertex lists of the 77 polytopes of Proposition 9.2:

- the lattice package (`milnor_kernels.py`): the boundary structure of the exceptional surfaces, the norms and pairings of the $K^\perp$ rows, the root decompositions, the (-2) -enumerations with rigorous search bounds, and the isometries to the standard del Pezzo markings;
- the matrix package (`global_kernel.py`): the reconstruction of all 36 rows from the printed data, the ranks, coloops, kernels, the four profiles and the enlarged profile with their forced-zero lists, and the criticality statement of Section 5.3(3);
- the period package (`dp_periods.py`): the exact fan combinatorics behind (2) (the ± 1 pairings on all rays, the divisor computation, the slice self-intersection patterns), the corner-chart transitions, and the constancy of the pullback in Lemma 3.2, verified to machine precision at random points;
- `examples.py`, the general implementation of Section 9, which recomputes every number of Section 5.3 for X° from the polytope, and the Δ_{19} and Δ_{20} computations, including the absence of nodal coloops on Δ_{20} ;
- the one-germ package (`lone_germ.py`): the reflexive 4-polytope Δ_7 of Section 9.2, its face inventory and admissibility, the rank-2 relation-row block and zero kernel, and the Hodge numbers $(4, 214)$;
- the census package (`classification.py`, reading the extract `framework_77.json`): the germ inventory, the matrix and the verdict for each of the 77 polytopes of Proposition 9.2, rebuilt from the stored vertex lists;

- the relation-row package (`relation_class.py`): for X° , X_{20} , X_{19} and X_7 , that every relation row satisfies $\sum_j a_j v_j = 0$ and $\sum_j a_j = 0$, carries coefficient zero at the interior lattice point, and that the rows at a germ span the whole ray-relation space of rank $n - 3$ (Proposition 8.2); together with the per-germ block ranks of Corollary 8.5 and an independent reconstruction of rank $B = 21$ for X° ;
- the kernel-equality package (`kernel_equality.py`): the vanishing of both Batyrev correction terms, and the reason each 2-face contributes zero, for $\Delta^\vee$, Δ , Δ_{20} , Δ_{19} , Δ_7 and all 77 census polytopes (Proposition 8.3);
- the mirror-partner package (`mirror_partner.py`): the reconstruction of the twenty-four rows of B_Δ from Tables 3 and 4, including the derivation of both exceptional surface lattices from the face data of Table 3, the reduced-rigidity of the $\mathbb{F}_1$ germ by the zero-sum test on its edge vectors, the two vanishing columns of item (3), the root decomposition $A_1 \oplus A_2$ of $K^\perp(\mathrm{dP}_6)$, the absence of (-2) -classes in $K^\perp(\mathbb{F}_1)$ and the square -8 of its generator, and the ranks, coloops and forced-zero lists of Section 7.

The fixed subdivision of Section 5.2 and its smoothness and projectivity are certified by an exact integral support function; the Batyrev regularity of the reference equation of X° , including nondegeneracy along every face, is certified at an integral witness (`resolution_fan.sage` and `global_section.sage`, with five further Sage certificates and the face-data module `fixed_example.py`). The subdivision of Section 7, its 94 unimodular maximal cones, the two stars and the twenty diagonals are certified the same way by `mirror_partner_fan.sage`.

The arXiv ancillary bundle includes this directory together with the shared exact toric modules used by the programs. The same files are public, together with the programs and data of the companion papers, at

<https://github.com/bwuebben/calabi-yau-smoothability>.

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